OAG ZIMBABWE
Office of the Auditor-General

SPECIAL AUDIT REPORT

of the

AUDITOR-GENERAL

on

ASSESSMENT OF THE DROUGHT RESPONSE MITIGATION PROGRAMME

by

MINISTRY OF PUBLIC SERVICE, LABOUR AND SOCIAL WELFARE



Presented to Parliament of Zimbabwe 2025

VFM 2025:03



SPECIAL AUDIT REPORT
of the
AUDITOR-GENERAL

on

ASSESSMENT OF THE DROUGHT RESPONSE MITIGATION PROGRAMME
by

MINISTRY OF PUBLIC SERVICE, LABOUR AND SOCIAL WELFARE

Presented to Parliament of Zimbabwe 2025

VFM 2025:03

OAG ZIMBABWE
Office of the Auditor-General

Ref 1/69/1764 VFM

The Hon. Minister J.G. Moyo
Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare
9th Floor, Kaguvi Building
Corner S.V Muzenda and Central Avenue
Harare

Dear Sir

I hereby submit a special audit report on Assessment of the Drought Response Mitigation Programme by the Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare in terms of Section 11 of the Audit Office Act *[Chapter 22:18]*.

Yours faithfully

R. Kujinga
ACTING AUDITOR-GENERAL

Harare
September 8, 2025

OAG Vision

To be the Centre of Excellence in the provision of Auditing Services.

OAG Mission

To examine, audit and report to Parliament on the management of public resources of Zimbabwe through committed and motivated staff with the aim of improving accountability and good corporate governance.

OAG Values



Table of Contents

Glossary of Terms i
List of Abbreviations ii
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY iii
Summary of findings iii
CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION 1
1.1 Background 1
1.2 Motivation 1
1.3 Organizational Structure 1
1.4 Funding 2
1.5 Audit Design 2
1.6 Audit Methodology 5
CHAPTER 2: SYSTEMS DESCRIPTION 6
2.1 Key Players 6
2.2 Process Description 7
CHAPTER 3: FINDINGS 12
3.1 Provision of Food Aid to Targeted Population 12
3.2 Compliance with FDMS Procedures 18
3.3 Disbursements of Cash for Cereal in Urban Areas 28
3.4 Payment of Travel and Subsistence Allowances to Staff Members 29
CHAPTER 4: CONCLUSIONS 32
CHAPTER 5: RECOMMENDATIONS 33
Annexures 35

List of Tables and Graphs

Tables

Table 1: Funding for the Programme. 2
Table 2: Sampling - Provinces with the most Food Insecure Households. 4
Table 3: Days when the Local GMB Depots in Districts visited did not have Grain. 14
Table 4: Outstanding Transporters Payments Age Analysis. 16
Table 5: Delayed Payments to Transporters. 16
Table 6: Potential Beneficiaries who were not Receiving Grain. 17
Table 7: Village Households where Food Aid was Collected by Proxies. 20
Table 8: Status of Vehicles in Provinces/Districts. 21
Table 9: Funds Disbursed to the Respective Provinces and Districts. 26
Table 10: Treasury Releases. 27
Table 11: CCWs Needed per District for the Cash for Cereal Programme. 29
Table 12: Outstanding Travel and Subsistence Allowances. 30

Graphs

Graph 1: Grain Required and Distributions by Province for the 1st Blitz. 13
Graph 2: Grain Required and Distributions by Province for the 2nd Blitz. 13
Graph 3: Cash for Cereal Disbursement as at October 31, 2024. 28

Glossary of Terms

Beneficiary: is a person or household entitled to receive food aid.

Blitz : a sudden rigorous effort to deal with something.

Paysheet : is a register signed by beneficiaries when receiving food aid.

List of Abbreviations

CCW	Community Care Worker
DDC	District Development Coordinator
DDRC	District Drought Relief Committee
DSD	Department of Social Development
DSDO	District Social Development Officer
FDMS	Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy
FNC	Food and Nutrition Council
FNSC	Food and Nutrition Security Committee
FDP	Food Distribution Point
GMB	Grain Marketing Board
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
MPSLSW	Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare
MT	Metric Tonnes
SDO	Social Development Officer
PDRC	Provincial Drought Relief Committee
PSDO	Provincial Social Development Officer
ZIMLAC	Zimbabwe Livelihood Assessment Committee
ZRP	Zimbabwe Republic Police

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The objective of the audit was to evaluate the efficiency and effectiveness of the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) programme from May 1, 2024 to October 31, 2024. The Ministry of Public Service, Labour, and Social Welfare has the mandate for social assistance. The President through Statutory Instrument Number 55 of 2024 declared the 2023/2024 agricultural season a state of national disaster following the El Nino-induced drought, which resulted in a food deficit in rural and urban areas. The Ministry then came up with a comprehensive Drought Response and Mitigation Plan. The plan intended among other activities to enhance Food Distribution and direct cash transfers to food insecure households.

The audit was motivated by the declaration of a State of National Disaster, which triggered resource mobilization efforts by the government, targeting all stakeholders including those in the diaspora, the United Nations, the International Community, and the private sector as was reported in the Sunday Mail of April 14, 2024.

Data collection methods used were documentary reviews, interviews, observations and questionnaires. The audit covered the period May 1, 2024 to October 31, 2024.

Summary of findings
My audit revealed weaknesses in the implementation of the Drought Response Mitigation Programme by the Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare. The weaknesses were as follows;

1. Provision of Food Aid to Targeted Population
The Ministry did not manage to provide food aid to all the targeted food insecure population during the period May 1 to October 31 2024. From the report dated July 31, 2024 for the 1st blitz, that is May to July, the Ministry managed to distribute 123 293 Metric Tonnes (MT) of grain to the total population of 5 479 709, eighty-nine percent (89%) against a targeted population of 6 140 924 and for the 2nd blitz August to October a total of 100 403 (MT) was distributed to a population of 4 488 244, seventy-two percent (72%) out of 6 215 775. During the 1st blitz only two (2) provinces Mashonaland Central and Matabeleland South managed to reach hundred percent 100% of their target, the least was Mashonaland East which was at seventy-one percent (71%). For the 2nd blitz the highest was Matabeleland South with ninety-five percent (95%) and the lowest was Midlands which had a coverage of fifty-six percent (56%).

The inadequate provision of grain to targeted population was attributable to delays in distributing the grain as planned and delays in payment of transporters.

1.1 Distribution of Grain
I noted that there were delays between the planned dates and the actual dates when grain was distributed in some districts. From the twelve (12) districts visited the average delay period ranged from three (3) to forty-one (41) days in the 1st blitz and five (5) to eighteen (18) days for the 2nd blitz. Delays to distribute grain was as a result of unavailability of grain at GMB depots.

1.1.1 Availability of Grain at Local GMB Depots
I noted that six (6) out of thirteen (13) districts were having challenges with grain availability to the

extent that the depots could spend five (5) to thirty-one (31) days without grain. The depots that experienced grain shortage were Goromonzi, Chipinge, Bulililma, Masvingo, Zaka and Mutare. This affected the distribution plan as they had to wait for grain to be delivered or send transporters to collect from depots where the grain was available.

1.2 Payments of Transporters

From ten (10) out of the thirteen (13) districts visited, the Ministry delayed in the payment of transporters and the amount involved was US$1 665 426. Of this amount, US$1 147 905 (69%) was still outstanding as at October 20, 2024 while US$517 521 (31%) had been paid. There was an average delay of seventy-six (76) days. As a result, some transporters stopped transporting grain due to these outstanding arrears and delays in payments.

2. Compliance with Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) Procedures

The programme was supposed to follow the procedures that were outlined in the FDMS manual. During my audit, I noted that some of the following procedures were not being fully adhered to.

2.1 Registration/Ranking of Beneficiaries

The majority of the ranking registers for the villages in the districts visited did not show the total number of households present during the registration to enable me to verify if the quorum was reached for ranking to take place. However, for Bulilima district all ranking registers audited were indicating the quorum that was present on the registration day. Furthermore, the majority of the village ranking registers in twelve (12) out of the thirteen (13) districts were not signed by the Village Heads and verified by the Food and Nutrition Council (FNC) chairpersons except for Bulilima.

In Masvingo district, there were seven (7) wards which had no evidence that the process for village ranking was followed or done. There were no ranking registers nor Form 1R completed. According to the interview with the District Social Development Officer (DSDO), beneficiary lists for the Wards were submitted by the DA's Office. There was a high risk that some of the beneficiaries for the programme were non deserving persons.

2.2 Beneficiary Verification

There was no evidence to confirm that beneficiary verifications were conducted in the visited districts except for Zaka district. However, all the other twelve (12) district heads confirmed that they were responding to anonymous calls whenever they were issues raised and also on distribution days when they will be calling out household names and total number of beneficiaries in each household. Verification of beneficiaries was not done in some districts due to shortage of vehicles to access villages/wards to carry out the verification processes. Eleven (11) out of the thirteen (13) Districts visited had no vehicles.

Furthermore, I noted that forty-eighty (48%) of the households' grain collections were done by proxies. There was no mechanism in place to follow up if the entitled beneficiaries had received the grain.

2.3 Controls on Grain Withdrawal from GMB, Transportation and Distribution

The Ministry complied largely with the controls on grain withdrawal, transportation and distribution as outlined in the manual. However, all the 733 withdrawal slips reviewed in the thirteen (13) districts visited were not signed by the Provincial Officers. Enquiries with the DSDOs revealed that they were preparing an itinerary which was sent for approval by the PSDOs instead of the withdrawal slips. There was no evidence that the grain delivery book was signed by the Food Distribution Committee as outlined in the FDMS manual.

2.4 Grain Quantities Issued to Beneficiaries

The Ministry had no standard measure for the 7.5kg grain allocation. They had no scales and measuring tins to ensure that correct grain quantities were issued to beneficiaries. I also noted that quantities issued to households were not specified on the paysheets, for instance five (5) villages in Buhera District, Ward twelve (12) were not specifying quantities given. These hindered verifications of the quantities signed for by the beneficiaries. There was a risk that grain quantities issued to beneficiaries may be more/less than the required or approved quantity.

2.5 Reconciliation of Grain with GMB

Eight (8) out of the thirteen (13) Districts visited were only preparing a list of grain withdrawn from the local GMBs without confirmation from the GMB depot managers on the grain that had been withdrawn. These were Marondera, Goromonzi, Masvingo, Zaka, Chiredzi, Mutare, Buhera and Chipinge districts. None performance of reconciliations between the grain dispatch/withdrawal slips and distribution sheets may have been caused by lack of enforcement by the Ministry on monthly basis. There was a risk that errors may not be identified in time and also it may result in abuse of grain.

2.6 Distances Travelled by Beneficiaries to Food Distribution Points (FDPs)

Five (5) DSDOs for Chiredzi, Masvingo, Umguza, Bubi and Marondera revealed that there were some FDPs where beneficiaries were travelling for more than the stipulated five (5) km radius. Chiredzi had seven (7) out of one hundred (100), Umguza had thirteen (13) out of fifty-nine (59) and Bubi had twenty-three (23) out of sixty-one (61) FDPs which had distances more than 5kms. In addition, Marondera had three (3) wards with one (1) food distribution point each with the furthest beneficiaries travelling for more than six (6) km to reach to the FDP. Interviews conducted revealed that some of these FDPs were impassible/inaccessible due to poor road network and in Matabeleland South transporters were hesitant to service the area because of the Kalahari sands. There was a risk that the elderly and those with health issues could fail to travel to the FDPs. In addition, beneficiaries could have a financial burden in terms of transport costs to travel to the FDPs and transport the received grain to their respective homes. From the 405 questionnaires administered, sixty-three (63) respondents indicated that they had financial burden in terms of transport cost to move grain to their homes.

2.7 Contracts with Transporters

From a review of the contract documents submitted for audit in the thirteen (13) districts visited, I noted that nine (9) out of the thirteen (13) districts had valid contracts whilst the other four (4) had no contracts. The DSDOs revealed that the districts had submitted copies of the contracts to Head

Office for signing in August 2024, the copies were not yet sent back to the respective districts as at October 20, 2024. There was no evidence that follow up was made with Head Office.

In addition, I noted from the contracts availed for audit inspection that the cost of transporting the grain was not stated in the contract. The prices were only highlighted on the due diligence reports and tender evaluation minutes. Possibilities of changes in prices were high in the absence of agreed price being stated in the contract which is the binding document.

2.8 Utilization of Disbursed Funds

A review of monthly reconciliations and acquittals for the period under review carried out in the districts visited revealed that the funds disbursed to provinces and districts amounting to ZWG141 788 000 were used for the intended purposes such as payment of transporters, training and payment of Travel and Subsistence allowances. However, no disbursements had been made to provinces for the 2nd blitz as at the date of concluding my audit on October 30, 2024. This affected the payments of transporters as some had stopped delivering the grain.

2.9 Monitoring and Evaluation

My audit revealed that the provincial officers were carrying out monitoring and evaluation of the programme as evidenced by weekly, monthly and quarterly monitoring and evaluation reports for the programme. The reports highlighted issues on implementation, processes, outcomes and challenges.

3. Disbursements of Cash for Cereal in Urban Areas

I noted that the Cash for Cereal transfers did not start in July as planned. The first disbursements were made on October 9, 2024. Only 28 875 (2%) out of the targeted population of 1.4 million beneficiaries nationwide had received the cash for cereal as at October 31, 2024. Delays in disbursement of cash for cereal was as a result of delays in training of the Community Care Workers (CCWs) and inadequate number of CCWs compared to the population which needed to be registered.

4. Payment of Travel and Subsistence Allowances to Staff Members

In the thirteen (13) districts visited, the Ministry was owing US$193 667 to officers for Travel and Subsistence allowances as at October 20, 2024. Some of the allowances had been outstanding since April 2024. However, Goromonzi and Mutare districts were up to date with the payment of Travel and Subsistence allowances. A review of the districts' budget statements also revealed that the Travel and Subsistence allowances were not being budgeted for. This had resulted in the districts failing to settle claims when they were due. None of the thirteen (13) districts visited were able to provide disbursement requests made to the Head Office for Travel and Subsistence allowances. Delays to pay Officers Travelling and Subsistence allowances may negatively impact on staff motivation.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. The Ministry should make sure that there is timeous coordination with GMB so that grain is readily available in all depots to enable the districts to obtain grain within reasonable distances. This will reduce the time travelled by transporters and time taken to deliver to the beneficiaries.

Movement of grain between depots should be properly planned with indicative dates to enable follow ups to be made. The Ministry should liaise with Treasury on the issue of timeous release of funds to pay transporters so that the programme activities are not interrupted by the absence of grain at GMB depots and due to non-payment of transporters. This will ensure that the food insecure population receive aid timeously.

2. The Ministry should make sure that all FDMS procedures from the registration, verification and payment of food aid are enforced to enhance accountability and transparency in the implementation of the programme. Furthermore;

2.1 The Ministry should ensure that the registration/ranking of villagers is conducted across all wards and villages to enhance transparency and integrity of the programme.

Due processes should be followed in identifying beneficiaries and avoid the District Development Officers (former DA Office) from providing lists of beneficiaries to the District Social Development Officers. This process is supposed to be carried out by the District Social Development Office and the villagers.

2.2 The Ministry should carry out beneficiary verifications in order to minimise inclusion of non-deserving and exclusion of deserving beneficiaries. Mechanisms to follow up on the beneficiaries whose food aid is collected by proxies should be developed. This will assist in determining the existence of the beneficiaries and whether they have received food aid. For the districts which did not have motor vehicles, alternative arrangements for transportation of staff such as hiring of vehicles should have been sought for the exercise to be done within reasonable time.

2.3 The Ministry should train staff members on how to complete the delivery books and also provide the delivery books to all the districts. This will assist in monitoring the movement of grain from GMB to the distribution centers. In cases, where the grain cannot be distributed on the same day, the consignment should be formally handed over to the Food Nutrition Committee so that it is safely secured overnight. All deliveries should have a police escort.

2.4 The Ministry should provide proper measuring containers/scales so that beneficiaries receive the correct quantities of grain and avoid estimations which might give room for misappropriation of grain.

2.5 The Ministry should ensure that grain reconciliations are made with GMB for accountability of the grain that would have been withdrawn and distributed in the provinces.

2.6 The Ministry in consultation with the Ward Food and Nutrition Committees should create other FDPs so that the distance travelled by beneficiaries is reduced. This will remove the financial burden for beneficiaries on transport costs.

2.7 The Ministry should expedite signing of contracts submitted by districts. In the case that disagreements arise with the contractors, it will be difficult to handle the issues without valid

contracts. In addition, the contract document should include the contract price for it to be complete and binding.

2.8 The Ministry should sustain the proper utilization of disbursed funds for the benefit of the people in need of food. In addition, the Ministry should intensify mobilization of financial resources to address the financial gaps so that more people receive food aid.

2.9 The Monitoring and Evaluation should be enhanced to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of the programme especially in cases where weaknesses and gaps would have been identified.

3. The Ministry should increase numbers and expedite the training of CCWs. This will assist registrations to be carried out in time and allow all food insecure population to receive aid.

4. The Ministry's budget formulation should be comprehensive to include provision for FDMS Travel and Subsistence Allowances so that staff are paid promptly.

The Ministry should strive to clear all outstanding Travel and Subsistence allowances and pay in time so that the well-being and morale of the staff implementing the programme is enhanced.

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

On April 3, 2024, the President, through Statutory Instrument Number 55 of 2024 declared the 2023/2024 agricultural season a state of national disaster following the El Nino-induced drought which resulted in food deficit in rural and urban areas. The Ministry of Public Service, Labour, and Social Welfare is the one mandated to manage social assistance matters. The Ministry came up with a comprehensive Drought Response and Mitigation Plan. The plan intended among other activities, to enhance social protection and provide direct cash transfers to affected households.

1.2 Motivation

According to the Sunday Mail of April 14, 2024, the declaration of a State of National Disaster triggered resource mobilization efforts by the government, targeting all stakeholders including those in the diaspora, the United Nations, the International Community and the private sector.

According to The Herald of March 6, 2024, Matabeleland North Province had the highest food insecure population with 42% requiring assistance. Furthermore, the Centre for Innovation and Technology News Zimbabwe an online publication, on July 29, 2024, published that Mzilikazi Ward 20 Councilor had raised serious concerns about the misappropriation of relief funds intended for the community's most vulnerable residents. The Councilor pointed fingers at unscrupulous community leaders posing as legitimate agents representing residents while diverting much-needed funds away from the less privileged. Speaking after the Mzilikazi Ward 20 Budget review meeting held at Mgoqo Primary School, the Councilor said this alarming development had exacerbated the struggles of those already facing severe hardships, undermining efforts to alleviate poverty and improve living conditions in the ward. She went on to say according to the Census, Ward 20 had 18 000 people, and 40 percent of the residents, about 8 000 people, were supposed to benefit from the El Nino fund.

I therefore decided to carry out a special audit to assess how the Ministry was managing the drought and response programme for the benefit of the intended beneficiaries.

1.3 Organizational Structure

The Ministry is headed by the Accounting Officer. Below the Accounting Officer are two (2) Chief Directors responsible for Labour Administration, Employment Services and Promotion, and Social Development and Disabilities Affairs. Below the Chief Director Social Development and Disabilities Affairs are two (2) Directors responsible for Disability Affairs and the other Director for Social Development. The Director for Social Development is responsible for the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy programme. Below the Director for Social Development are ten (10) Provincial Social Development Officers (PSDOs) followed by the District Social Development Officers (DSDOs). Refer to **Annexure A** for more details. Further to the structure of the Ministry, the programme has four (4) Committees which assist in the programme implementation. The Committees' responsibilities are outlined in paragraph 2.1.1 to 2.1.4.

1.4 Funding

The source of funding for the programme was mainly from Treasury. Table 1 below has a summary of what was received for the period.

Table 1: Funding for the Programme.

Period 2024	Amount ZWG$	Mid-rate as at May 13, 2024 and July 16, 2024	US$ Equivalent
May	34 150 000	13.48	2 533 383
July	113 638 000	13.76	8 258 576
Total			**US$10 791 959**

Source: FDMS Release Letters.

1.5 Audit Design

The audit design outlines the audit objective, audit scope, audit questions and criterion, and sampling.

1.5.1 Audit Objective

To evaluate the efficiency and effectiveness of the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) programme.

1.5.2 Audit Scope

The audit focused on the activities of the FDMS programme after the declaration by His Excellence, The President, on the El Nino-induced drought and the audit covered the period from May 2024 to October 31, 2024.

1.5.3 Audit Questions and Criteria

AQ:1 Did the Ministry manage to disburse food aid to the targeted population for 1st and 2nd blitz?

AC:1 According to the Food Deficit Mitigation monthly report for May 2024 the MPSLSW was targeting a total national population of 6 140 924 requiring 138 170 Metric Tonnes (MT) of grain for the 1st blitz. For the second blitz the target was 6 215 775 requiring 139 855 (MT).

AQ:1.1 Were there delays in grain distribution?

AC:1.1 According to interviews with management, the district office prepares an itinerary for all wards and sends it to the DDRC and provincial office for approval before distribution of grain to wards. According to the national plan to move grain, the Ministry was supposed to move grain between depots with surplus to those with deficit.

AQ:1.2 Are transporters being paid on time?

AC:1.2 According to Section 5 of the contract documents between the MPSLSW and transporters, payments to contractors shall be made within 30 days after the presentation of properly signed documentation as proof of delivery.

AQ:2 Were the provisions of the FDMS Manual complied with in the distribution of food aid?

AQ:2.1 Is the approved DDRC list supported by signed village ranking list indicating quorum on the day of ranking, paysheets at district level and paysheets at distribution points?

AC:2.1 Section 2.2.3 and 2.2.4 of the FDMS manual states that the approved DDRC list must be supported by the signed village ranking list indicating quorum on the day of ranking, pay sheets at the district level, and pay sheets at the distribution point. Facilitators should ensure that at least 80% of the households in the village are available.

AQ:2.2 Are grain allocation lists approved by the DDRC?

AC:2.2 According to Section 2.5 of the FMDS Manual, following the registration of beneficiaries, it is critical to undertake beneficiary verification to minimise inclusion and exclusion errors.

AQ:2.3 Are there adequate mechanisms in place for the collection, transportation, and custody of grain at distribution centers?

AC:2.3 According to the FDMS Manual section 10.7, prior Provincial Officer's authority should be sought in writing for the withdrawal of grain for any ward and the province should keep a record of all the withdrawals done. The district uses a DSO-approved grain withdrawal slip with full details such as the quantity, name of ward, truck details including the name of the driver, and his ID Number to withdraw grain from the GMB. The grain withdrawal slip should be written in duplicate. The DSDO is accompanied by a police officer to withdraw and transport grain from the nearest GMB deport. On issuance of the grain, the GMB deport manager originates a grain release order and withdrawal shall be made in the morning where grain is left at the ward overnight, the Ward Food and Nutrition Committee should look after the grain. Distribution shall be done during the day.

AQ:2.4 Was the food aid distributed enough to cover the food-insecure households in districts?

AC:2.4 According to section 10.8 of the FDMS manual and the ZimLac report 2024, each beneficiary is required to receive a three-month allocation of grain at once which was pegged at 7.5kg per person per month for the period May to October 2024.

AQ:2.5 Does the Ministry maintain stock records and reconciliations for grain at each GMB Depot?

AC:2.5 According to section 10.17 of the FDMS Manual, at the end of each disbursement blitz, a copy of the duly acquitted pay sheets should together with a copy of the voucher be submitted to GMB for purposes of reconciliation of grain summarizing the grain withdrawal slips issued in the month and DSO should send the signed copy to the province for consolidation and onwards submission to Head Office.

AQ:2.6 Are distribution points within the stipulated traveling distance?

AC:2.6 According to Section 3.5 of the Food Drought Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) manual, the Food Distribution Point shall not be more than 5km from the community.

AQ:2.7 Are there valid contracts for all transporters?

AC:2.7 According to section 10.13.4 of the FDMS Manual, contracts of engagement for transporters should be drawn and signed before transportation of grain commence.

AQ:2.8 Were the disbursed funds used for the intended purposes?

AC:2.8 According to section 10.4 of the FDMS Manual, the drought relief Fund Account shall be solely used for the intended purpose as provided for in the constitution.

AQ:2.9 Is monitoring and evaluation being conducted weekly, monthly and quarterly by the provincial Monitoring and Evaluation officers as prescribed in the manual.

AC:2.9 According to section 9 of the FDMS Manual the Ministry, through the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Department shall conduct monthly, quarterly and annual monitoring on the programme implementation, processes and outcomes.

AQ:3 Was the Ministry paying Travel and Subsistence Allowance to officers on time?

AC:3 Section 65 (6) of the Public Finance Management (Treasury Instructions), 2019 states that Officers may, on application, be paid a subsistence allowance in advance as the Accounting Officer may authorize. The subsistence allowance shall cover the cost of meals and accommodation when an Officer is away from their home station.

AQ:4 Was cash for cereal disbursed on time to beneficiaries?

AC:4 According to the Cash for Cereal Programme Urban Response for The El Nino -Induced Drought Document the programme was supposed to commence with the registration of potential beneficiaries while transfers were expected to commence after the verification process as from July 2024 until March 2025.

AQ:4.1 Were the Child Care Workers used for the urban registration programme adequate and trained on time?

AC:4.1 According to interviews with the Programme Officer, all Child Care Workers must undergo security vetting.

1.5.4 Sampling

The sampling was based on the statistics provided in the 2024 Zimbabwe Livelihood Assessments Committee (ZimLAC) report. I selected provinces with the most food insecure households coupled with the grain distributions that had been made in the 1st blitz as shown in the following Table.

Table 2: **Sampling - Provinces with the most Food Insecure Households.**

Province	Proportion of Food Insecure Households (%)	Estimated Food Insecure Population
Mashonaland East	58	925 210
Manicaland	60	1 087 314
Matebeleland North	57	427 389

Matebeleland South	50	327 386
Masvingo	56	839 503

Source: 2024 Zimbabwe Livelihood Assessments Committee Report.

1.6 Audit Methodology

I used the following methods of collecting data;

- Documentary reviews,
- Interviews,
- Observations and
- Questionnaires.

1.6.1 Documentary Review

Documentary reviews were done to gather information on the operations, processes, procedures, and policies related to the Drought Response and Mitigation Strategy programme by the Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare. Documents reviewed included the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy Manuals, Budgets and Plans for the programme, Circulars from the Ministry, programme reports, internal audit reports, monitoring reports, fuel registers, contract documents, acquittals, minutes of committees, disbursement reports, ranking registers and Paysheets among others. For more details, refer to **Annexure B**.

1.6.2 Interviews

Interviews were carried out during the audit with Ministry Officials responsible for the Drought Response and Mitigation Strategy programme and other relevant key players to gather information as well as corroborate other information obtained from documentary reviews. These included Programme Officer, Director Human Resources, Director Internal Audit, Director Finance, Provincial Social Development Officers, District Social Development Officers, and District Development Coordinators.

1.6.3 Observations

I observed activities at three (3) distribution points to appreciate how the process was done.

1.6.4 Questionnaires

405 questionnaires were administered to Councillors**,** Village Heads and the beneficiaries of the programme to confirm if they had received the grain as well as other challenges and problems they were facing.

CHAPTER 2: SYSTEMS DESCRIPTION

2.1 Key Players

The Ministry of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare has the major responsibility for the implementation of the FDMS programme. It has a number of committees from the Provincial to District level which assist in the programme implementation. The committees are made up of members from various Ministries. These are highlighted below;

2.1.1 Provincial Drought Relief Committee (PDRC)

This committee is chaired by the Permanent Secretary for Provincial Affairs and Devolution and the Provincial Social Development Officer as the secretariat. The other members are from the Ministries of Agriculture, Health, Women and Small to Medium Enterprises, Education, Youth, Grain Marketing Board and Zimbabwe Republic Police among others. The roles of the committee are as follows:

i. Evidence-based District level targeting – this involves collecting and analyzing data for the selection of beneficiaries at the district level.
ii. Coordination of food security interventions.
iii. Monitoring and Evaluation of the programme.
iv. Grievance handling.
v. Information dissemination.
vi. Resource mobilization.
vii. Data management.
viii. Reporting programme activities.
ix. Quality assurance and technical support and
x. Participation in vulnerability assessments.

2.1.2 District Drought Relief Committee (DDRC)

It is chaired by the District Development Coordinator's Office, and the Department of Social Development as the Secretariat and implementing agent. The other members include,

- Ministry of Lands, Agriculture, Fisheries, Water and Rural Development.
- Ministry of Health and Child Care.
- Ministry of Women and Small to Medium Enterprises.
- Ministry of Primary and Secondary Education.
- Ministry of Youth, Sports, Arts and Recreation.
- Rural District Councils.
- Development Partners and
- Zimbabwe Republic Police.

The DDRC plays an oversight role of all FDM activities in the district. The other roles are as follows:

Pre-distribution

It includes activities such as identification, registration, verification of beneficiaries and drawing up monthly food distribution plans and teams. The secretariat shall be accountable for the implementation of the programme in liaison with the Ward Food and Nutrition Committee, sensitization and mobilization of beneficiaries, facilitating community-level logistical arrangements such as transport, storage, and distribution of food aid, grievance handling and management of significant incidents, monitoring and supervision and participation in vulnerability assessments.

Food Distribution
At the food distribution point, the DDRC shall conduct a de-briefing with the community leaders on the activities of the day. The DDRC and the community leadership shall conduct a pre-distribution address. Programme participants are then organised for distribution. Priority should be given to older persons, persons with disabilities and those with chronic conditions.

Post Distribution
Post distribution activities involve;
i. Monitoring and Evaluation.
ii. Grievance handling and management of significant incidents.
iii. Compilation of reports.
iv. Submission of statistical and financial returns.

2.1.3 Ward Food and Nutrition Security Committee (WFNSC)
This committee is chaired by the Agricultural and Rural Development Advisory Services (AARDS) Officer and the other members include but are not limited to a Community Child Care Worker (CCW), a Women Affairs Officer, Youth Officer, a Traditional leader, and ZRP. Its roles are:
i. Identification and evaluation of mistakes made during the selection process.
ii. Grievance handling.
iii. Oversees all activities and interventions related to food and nutrition security.
iv. Mobilization and sensitization of the beneficiaries.

2.1.4 Food Distribution Point Committee (FDPC)
The committee is composed of beneficiaries that receive entitlements at that particular food distribution point. These are nominated by the beneficiaries and the composition should be gender and disability sensitive. Its roles are:
i. Mobilizing and coordinating community meetings relating to food distribution.
ii. Maintain order during distribution.
iii. Report incidences of malpractice such as group sharing at the FDP.
iv. Facilitate offloading and security of the commodities prior, during and after distributions.
v. Checking and signing of approved beneficiary list and grain delivery book at community level.

2.2 Process Description
According to the FDMS Manual, the process description for food deficit mitigation activities is as outlined below.

2.2.1 Targeting/Identification of beneficiaries Mechanisms
Identification of beneficiaries are at various levels, the first being geographical targeting at the National Level, District Level, Ward Level and Village Level.

National Level
This is guided by results of national assessments conducted by the Zimbabwe Livelihoods Assessment Committee (ZimLAC), together with information from district profiles, poverty assessments, the Consolidated Approach of Reporting Indicators for food security (CARI), and other relevant secondary information such as information from the Crop and Livestock Assessments.

District Level
Targeting of districts is informed by the prevalence of food insecurity, confirmed poverty levels and forecasted resources as well as the scale of other partners' programmes. Preference is given

to districts with the highest/worst phase classification. Furthermore, within those districts, precedence is given to household groups in worse phase classification.

Ward prioritization and allocation of beneficiary numbers is the prerogative of the District Drought Relief Committee (DDRC). The DDRC prioritizes the wards on the basis of their levels of food insecurity, using a combination of available data (e.g. from district profiles, Seasonal Livelihood Programme (SLP) reports etc.) and the members' expert knowledge of the district.

It is expected that the percentage of benefiting people is higher in wards with higher levels of food insecurity and vice versa. Commodities/cash provided by FDMS shall be distributed free of charge, without discrimination and in complete fairness, regardless of race, religion, disability, nationality, political opinion or gender, without linking assistance, either directly or indirectly to any religious or political persuasion guided by the humanitarian principles.

After the stakeholder meeting, the Social Development Officer (SDO), who participates as the secretariat in the DDRC meeting, is required to prepare a report outlining the prioritisation process, including the tables showing ward ranking and the beneficiary numbers allocated to each ward, a description of how the process was conducted and justification for the ranking.

Ward Level

Ward Assembly mobilisation/meeting stage:

The ward Chairperson of the Food and Nutrition Security Committee (FNSC), through the local leadership calls for a Ward Assembly meeting which is to be attended by the local community leadership (Chiefs, Headmen, Ward Councilors, Government ward level staff from different Ministries and Departments present in the concerned ward, Village Heads and their Village Secretaries (for documentation)). Village Heads should be requested to bring their respective updated household village registers.

The Committee should note the following:

i. Only registered villages from the DDC's Office should be considered to avoid village splitting and or the creation of temporary 'food assistance villages' in the communities.

ii. FNSC should first hold a brief meeting with the Ward Leadership to inform them about the purpose of the meeting.

iii. DDRC members are supposed to provide full information on the FDMS programme to all levels. This is done on a public address where ZimLAC findings, FDMS objectives and other programme related issues are discussed.

iv. Ward Assemblies should first rank villages with assistance from Agritex Extension workers as well as other relevant government personnel in the ward. In addition, allocation of percentage of food insecure households should be done based on food security status of a village.

v. Each Village Head should avail their village information (total households and population residing in the village) which is used in the determination of beneficiaries for each village. SDO should also get population figures from DDC/RDC offices and compare with lists provided by village heads.

Village Level

On registration day all the people from a ward are gathered at a ward Centre or at a prospective distribution centre if the ward is too big for all the people to come for registrations in one place. FNSC and partners should first hold a meeting with village heads and their secretaries to discuss with them the purpose of the meeting.

A public address then follows where ZimLAC findings, FDMS objectives and other programme related issues are discussed. In cases where eligible beneficiaries are not able to physically take part in the targeting and registration process, due to mobility challenges associated with persons with disability, child headed families, older persons, chronically ill persons, a proxy is appointed by the beneficiary.

Before household registrations begin in each village, a quorum should be established. Facilitators should ensure that at least 80% of the households in the village are available. The basis for establishing availability of quorum will be the village list from the village secretary and cross-checking with the villagers if every household is included. To ensure 80% target is reached, various mobilisation strategies should be employed. Communication channels to be employed include the Councilors being the entry points, the Chiefs, Village Heads, local schools, and public notices.

During the ranking process, facilitators should ensure that all the households are ranked using the agreed village-based food insecurity indicators starting with the most food insecure to the least food secure households. It is therefore, necessary to identify all the households benefiting in other food assistance programmes to minimise duplication of effort or double dipping. The DDRC should gather all the necessary details regarding pre-existing food assistance programmes prior to beneficiary registrations with assistance from district officials.

In order to guard against unfair ranking, all households in a village can physically be ranked first and then when the whole village is satisfied with everybody's rank, all names of household heads can be listed on the ranking sheet/form starting with the most food insecure up to the last. This is done on a primary register (ranking register) following their ranking order. For each household head, the ID number, age, sex and household size should be openly/publicly given by the other villagers to guard against household size inflation.

After all households in a village have been ranked and recorded in the initial (ranking/primary) register (or simply a village ranking form), the DDRC can then establish the village cut off position and politely thank all for participating before dismissing those beyond the given cut off point. Only those within the cut off limit would be registered in the FDMS programme. The DDRC will keep a signed copy of the ranking form whilst each village head should also keep a copy of the same.

2.2.2 Distribution Modalities and Procedures

After targeting, verification and data cleaning, a beneficiary distribution list is generated or compiled. The District Drought Relief Committee shall sensitize communities on the dates of distribution and should consider customs, religious beliefs and in accordance with humanitarian principles. The communities shall set up food distribution points (FDP) in consultation with the Ward Food and Nutrition Committees. The FDP shall not be more than 5km away from the community. Programme participants shall nominate members to be part of the food distribution committee at the FDP and the committee changes in every phase.

2.2.3 Procedure for the Withdrawal of Grain

The District Office receives grain allocation lists approved by the District Drought Relief Committee. The grain withdrawal slip is a security item which should be recorded and issued in the security items register following the correct sequential order. District offices should ensure that they have adequate withdrawal slips since on no account should officers improvise and use other forms of stationery as grain withdrawal slips. Prior Provincial Officer's authority should be

sought in writing for the withdrawal of grain for any ward. The provincial office should keep a record for all the withdrawals done.

The accountant or duly authorized originating officer originates serialized grain withdrawal slip with full details as of the quantity, name of ward, truck details including the name of the driver and his identification number. The grain withdrawal slip should be written in duplicate. The grain withdrawal slip must be approved by the District Social Development Officer after checking for completeness and accuracy and then endorses with the Departmental stamp.

The designated District Social Development Officer accompanied by duly assigned Police Officer will take the Grain withdrawal slips to the nearest GMB depot. On no account shall grain be withdrawn without a Police Officer and District Social Development Officer. On issuance of the grain the GMB depot manager shall originate a grain dispatch/release order or tax invoice. Withdrawal of grain shall be done in the morning to avoid overnight storage which is detrimental to both beneficiaries and officers. Where this is not possible, the Driver of the truck ferrying grain should park the vehicle at a nearby police station. Where the grain is left at the ward overnight, the Ward Food and Nutrition Committee should look after the grain. Distributions shall be done during the day.

A paysheet shall be prepared to show beneficiary data disaggregated according to sex, age, and disability, with full details as to the ID number address, and contact details. Beneficiaries will sign upon receiving the food aid.

2.2.4 Monitoring and Evaluation

The Ministry has an established Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Department. They use the Social Protection Monitoring and Evaluation Framework (SPM&EF, 2021) which encompasses the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) results framework.

The structure of the FDMS M&E framework and data flow follows the bottom-up approach. The data collection process starts from the community level and is administered by the DDRC. The PDRC consolidates data at the provincial level through the Provincial M&E Officer. Monitoring shall be conducted weekly, monthly, quarterly and annually on the programme implementation, processes and outcomes. At national level the Department of Social Development and partners shall jointly undertake regular monitoring activities as follows:

The monitoring and evaluation process shall entail the following:
i. Routine Monitoring, which includes collection of routine data, monitoring processes, output and elements of outcomes.
ii. Evaluations and Surveys, which includes collection of outcome data, baselines, formative, midterm and end-line/impact evaluations.

2.2.5 Disbursement of Funds to Provinces and Districts

The National Drought Relief Fund shall disburse funds to Provincial and District Social Development bank accounts opened by the respective offices for the implementation of the FDMS. Signatories at the Provincial level should include the Provincial Social Development

Officer and Director for Finance and Administration within the Ministry of Local Government and Public Works. At the district level CEOs, DDC, and Social Development Officers are the authorized signatories. In any case, one Officer from Social Development with either P/DDC or CEO must sign.

The Provincial and District Social Development Officers shall acknowledge receipt of the disbursed funds by issuing out an official stamped receipt. The Drought Relief Fund account shall solely be used for its intended purpose. Up to fifteen percent (15%) of the advanced funds shall be utilized for administrative costs excluding procurement of assets. This administration percent shall vary from time to time depending on the decisions taken by management.

At the end of each month, a bank reconciliation must be prepared and the bank statements be attached. Each Provincial/District Office should each month submit the following to the Head Office:

i. Receipt in acknowledgment of amounts disbursed in advance.
ii. Acquittals as per the budget line items.
iii. All acquittals should reach Head Office by the 7th of the following month.
iv. The Head of Office should check and sign all the registers and cash books at least once every month.

2.2.6 Grain Withdrawn Reconciliation with GMB

At the end of each disbursement blitz, a copy of the duly acquitted grain distribution pay sheets should together with a copy of the voucher be submitted to GMB. These would assist the office and GMB in undertaking the reconciliation exercise. The reconciliation should be agreed with the GMB Depot manager and both parties should sign. The DSDO then sends the signed copy to the provincial offices for consolidation and onward submission to the Head Office.

CHAPTER 3: FINDINGS

This Chapter details my findings on the activities of the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy (FDMS) programme.

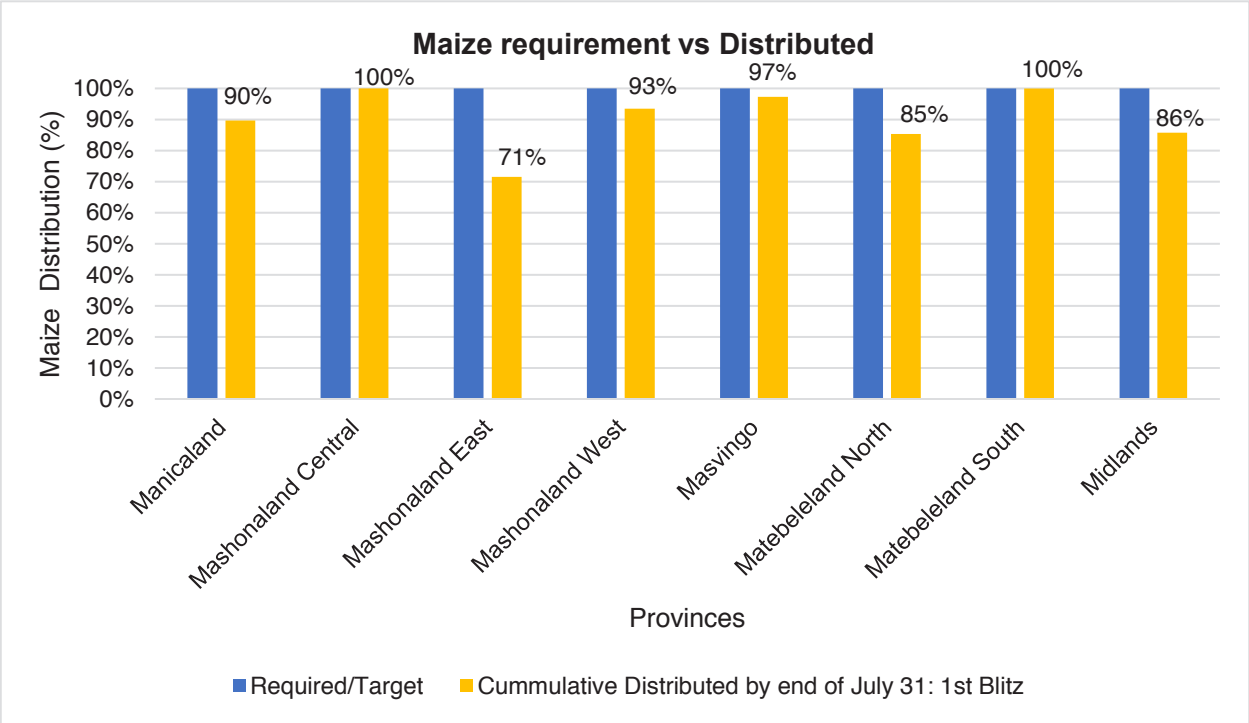
3.1 Provision of Food Aid to Targeted Population

According to the Food Deficit Mitigation Strategy monthly report for May 31, 2024, the Ministry of Public Service, Labour, and Social Welfare targeted to distribute to all provinces 138 170 Metric Tonnes (MT) of food aid in rural areas to a total population of 6 140 924. The first grain distribution was conducted between May 1 and July 31, 2024. From the report dated July 31, 2024 for the 1st blitz the Ministry managed to distribute 123 293 (MT) of grain to a total population of 5 479 709 (89%). Only two (2) provinces Mashonaland Central and Matabeleland South managed to reach the hundred percent (100%) target, the least was Mashonaland East which was at seventy-one percent (71%) coverage.

There was a slight increase in the targeted population and targeted grain requirements for the 2nd blitz which was August to October 31, 2024 from 6 140 924 to 6 215 775 and from 138 170 (MT) to 139 855 (MT) respectively. As at October 31, 2024 the Ministry had managed to distribute 100 403 (MT) of grain against a target of 139 855 (MT) to a total population of 4 468 309, about seventy-two percent (72%), thus a decrease by seventeen percent (17%) from 1st blitz. All the provinces were above fifty percent (50%) distribution coverage with Matabeleland South having the highest coverage of ninety-five percent (95%) and Mashonaland East eighty-seven percent (87%) respectively. Midlands, Masvingo, Mashonaland West and Mashonaland Central provinces were ranging from fifty-six percent (56%) to seventy percent (70%) coverage with Midlands province having the least coverage of fifty-six percent (56%).

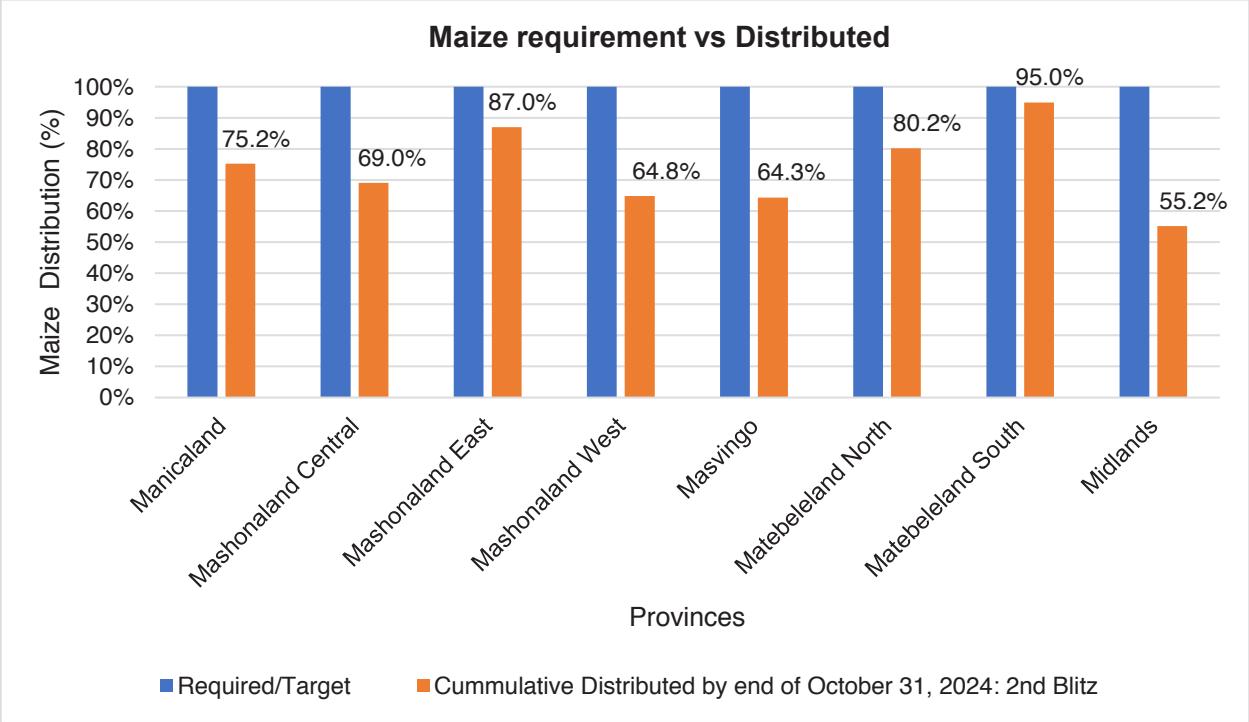
The following graphs show the percentages of grain requirements and distributions by province as at July 31, 2024 and October 31, 2024. For the detailed information on provinces and districts refer to **Annexure C.**

Graph 1: Grain Required and Distributions by Province for the 1st Blitz.



Source: Distribution report as at July 31, 2024.

Graph 2: Grain Required and Distributions by Province for the 2nd Blitz.



Source: Distribution report as at October 31, 2024.

Delays in the provision of food aid to targeted population was caused by delays to distribute grain as planned and delays in paying transporters.

3.1.1 Distribution of Grain

Following the targeting, registration, ranking processes and preparation of paysheets, the district office prepares an itinerary for all wards and sends it to the DDRC and provincial office for approval before withdrawal of grain from GMB. I noted that there were delays between the planned dates and the actual dates when grain was distributed in some districts. From the twelve (12) out of thirteen (13) districts visited the average delay period ranged from three (3) to forty-one (41) days in the 1st blitz and five (5) to eighteen (18) days for the 2nd blitz. Zaka and Mutare districts did not prepare itinerary for grain distributions, I was therefore, not able to ascertain whether distributions were done as per plan or not. The district officers indicated that their distribution was subject to availability of grain at GMB. Refer to **Annexure D** for the detailed delay periods. Delays to distribute grain was as a result of unavailability of grain at GMB depots.

Delays to distribute grain as planned may have resulted in beneficiaries staying for more than three months without receiving food aid.

3.1.1.1 Availability of Grain at Local GMB Depots

The Ministry's plan was to move grain from GMB depots with surplus to those with deficit to enable districts to withdraw grain from their local GMB depots. The plan for movement of grain could not be done on time to meet the demand of the various GMB depots. However, I noted that the plan had no dates for the proposed grain movement. In addition, according to interviews with six (6) out of thirteen (13) DSDOs revealed that the six (6) districts were having challenges with grain availability. Furthermore, review of reports on the actual distributions made revealed that in the six (6) districts, the GMB depots would spend five (5) to thirty-one (31) days without grain. This affected the distribution plan as they had to wait for grain to be delivered or send transporters to collect from GMB depots where the grain was available. However, this had an effect on the transportation costs as the distance covered had increased from the initial agreed distance. The following Table shows districts which did not have grain for distribution on particular periods during May 1, 2024 to October 19, 2024.

Table 3: Days when the Local GMB Depots in Districts visited did not have Grain.

GMB Depots	Date from when there was no grain	Date when grain was available	Number of days when Districts had no grain
Goromonzi	13/06/24	08/07/24	25
	07/08/24	20/08/24	14
	01/09/24	09/09/24	9
Chipinge	05/07/2024	09/07/2024	5
	05/08/2024	17/08/2024	12
	12/09/2024	17/09/2024	5
	22/09/2024	26/09/2024	5

	01/10/2024	12/10/2024 (date of audit)	10
Bulilima	01/08/24	13/08/2024	13
	30/08/24	22/09/24	24
	24/09/2024	29/09/24	6
Masvingo	27/09/2024	19/10/2024 (date of audit)	23
Zaka	18/06/2024	25/06/2024	8
	15/07/2024	20/07/2024	5
	01/08/2024	01/09/2024	31
	24/09/2024	16/09/2024 (date of audit)	13
Mutare	20/05/2024	29/05/2024	9
	13/06/2024	16/06/2024	4
	23/06/2024	30/07/2024	8
	10/07/2024	17/07/2024	7
	24/09/2024	09/10/2024 (date of audit)	18

Source: Reports on Actual Distribution made.

Districts such as Buhera had to transport grain from depots as far as Rusape (120km), Chiendambuya (184 km), Timbermills (180 km) and Middle Sabi (180 km). In addition, in Bubi district, based on interviews with DSDO and Accountant on October 10, 2024, I noted that there was a stoppage in distribution of grain for the period September 19, 2024 to October 10, 2024 coming to a total of twenty-two (22) days without distributions taking place. The transporter had indicated incapacitation in transporting food aid from GMB Bulawayo depot which was eighty (80 km) away from the wards in Bubi as was previously agreed.

3.1.2 Payments to Transporters

There were delays in paying transporters for both 1st and 2nd blitz contrary to Article 5.2 of the contract which states that payments shall be made within thirty (30) days after presentation of properly signed documentation as proof of delivery (invoices) by the Transporters. From ten (10) out of the thirteen (13) districts visited, the Ministry delayed in making payments to transporters amounting to US$1 665 426. Of this amount, US$1 147 905 (69%) was still outstanding as at October 31, 2024 and US$517 521 (31%) had been paid though there was an average delay of seventy-six (76) days. As a result, some transporters stopped transporting grain due to these outstanding arrears and delays in payments. For instance, in Chiredzi the transporters had stopped carrying grain since September 21, 2024 because they had not received their payments from the 1st blitz, US$66 282 (ZWG914 029) and 2nd blitz, US$201 083 (ZWG5 767 060). They only made deliveries to nearby FDPs. The FDPs which were far from the district were the most

affected. As at the date of audit on October 15, 2024, fifteen (15) FDPs with a total caseload/population of 29 333 had not received grain between August 25 and 29, 2024. The transporters had stopped transporting grain due to delayed payments. Table 4 below presents outstanding payments owed to transporters as at October 20, 2024 and Table 5 shows delayed payments made.

Table 4: Outstanding Transporters Payments Age Analysis.

District	Invoices Within 30 Days Old		Invoices Above 30 Days But <=60		Invoices Above 60 Days But <=90		Invoices Above 90 Days But <=120		Invoices Above 120 Days Old		Totals US$
	No of Invoices	Amount US$	No of Invoices	Amount US$	No of Invoices	Amount US$	No of Invoices	Amount US$	No of Invoices	Amount US$	
Chipinge	2	34 842	6	151 167	3	71 429	4	96 046	2	36 771	390 255
Mutare	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	142 446	142 446
Zaka	0	0	2	72 708	0	0	0	0	1	33 039	105 747
Chiredzi	0	0	1	201 083	0	0	0	0	0	66 282	267 365
Marondera	1	55 663	1	10 458	0	0	0	0	0	0	66 121
Umguza	0	0	3	46 232	2	38 847	4	61 057	0	0	146 136
Gwanda	0	0	0	0	1	29 835	0	0	0	0	29 835
Totals		**90 505**		**481 648**		**140 111**		**157 103**		**278 538**	**US$ 1 147 905**
							ZWG Equivalent as at 31 October 2024				**ZWG 32 921 915**

Source: Grain Transporter Invoices.

Table 5: Delayed Payments to Transporters.

District	Invoice Date	Payment Date	Amount US$	Period of Delay in Days
Buhera	15/2/2024	6/8/2024	1 364	173
	11/6/2024	6/8/2024	82 938	56
Umguza	28/3/2024	14/8/2024	60 196	139
	28/6/2024	14/8/2024	62 758	47
Bulilima	23/5/2024	5/8/2024	20 577	74
	30/5/2024	5/8/2024	14 673	67
	30/5/2024	5/8/2024	55 691	67
	4/6/2024	5/8/2024	29 976	62
	15/6/2024	5/8/2024	24 249	51
	15/6/2024	5/8/2024	50 553	51
	18/6/224	5/8/2024	37 894	48
	19/6/2024	5/8/2024	32 990	47
	30/6/2024	5/8/2024	24 496	36
Gwanda	1/3/2024	30/5/2024	6 945	90
	1/3/2024	30/6/2024	4 726	121
	1/3/2024	30/5/2024	7 495	90
Average Days Delayed				**76**
Total			**US$517 521**	
	ZWG equivalent as at	**October 31, 2024**	**ZWG14 842 502**	

Source: Invoices and Payment Vouchers.

According to a review of requests for funding and Treasury Release Letters, there were delays in the release of funds, for instance, a request for funding made on June 27, 2024 was released on July 16, 2024 resulting in a delay of 18 days. Furthermore, from interviews with the thirteen (13) DSDOs in the districts visited it was indicated that non-payment of transporters on time was as a result of delays in the release of funds by Treasury. The delay in distribution of food to targeted beneficiaries may result in severe malnutrition to the food insecure people.

Furthermore, my review of village ranking registers in ten (10) out of the thirteen (13) districts visited revealed that forty-one percent (41%) of the potential beneficiaries who were food insecure could not benefit because of limited grain allocation. In addition, from the 405 questionnaires administered all the 405 villagers raised concerns on the inadequacy of the grain distributed as some had to share with those that had not received, therefore the allocation could not last for the three (3) months. The Table below shows number of potential beneficiaries who were not receiving food aid.

Table 6: Potential Beneficiaries who were not Receiving Grain.

District	Total Villages Sampled	Total Number of Villagers as per Ranking Sheets	Total Number of Villagers receiving food aid	Potential Beneficiaries who did not receive food aid	Percentage of Potential Beneficiaries who did not receive food aid
Bubi	53	16 256	10 495	5 761	35%
Bulilima	157	79 844	48 712	31 132	39%
Gwanda	143	99 968	68 689	31 279	31%
Marondera	679	100 828	65 174	35 654	35%
Buhera	100	29 350	17 830	11 520	39%
Mutare	61	38 480	17 286	21 194	55%
Chipinge	72	43 874	15 931	27 943	64%
Chiredzi	58	23 437	11 516	11 921	51%
Zaka	61	18 856	10 106	8 750	46%
Masvingo	61	14 340	9 417	4 923	34%
Total	**1 445**	**465 233**	**275 156**	**190 077**	**41%**

Source: Village Ranking sheets and Paysheets.

However, in Umguza District Ward 13 and in Chiredzi District Ward 32, the list of beneficiaries on the village ranking registers and the paysheets were not a true reflection of the status of the food insecure households as the villagers had adopted a household capping system. For instance, in Umguza district Ward 13, Seafield 1 and 2 villages had capped beneficiaries at three (3) and four (4) per household as well as Teakdale 2 and 4 villages had capped at five (5) and four (4) beneficiaries per household respectively. Chiredzi District Ward 32, Chifuwa, Mangwengwe,

Chauke 7, Chikanya 6 and Gezani 7 villages had capped beneficiaries at four (4) to five (5) and three (3) per household.

Management Response

The observations are acknowledged. The Ministry submits its grain requirements for the release of grain as soon as the ZimLAC Assessment results are out. The requests are disaggregated by district and by province which makes it easier for coming up with a distribution plan. The depot-to-depot movement of grain is the prerogative of the Grain Marketing Board (GMB). However, GMB usually cite inadequate funding for transporting grain as per plan. Regular follow-ups for release of funds for both the Ministry and GMB are made with Treasury. The programme had not been adequately funded.

With regards on the numbers to be targeted in the area, the Ministry is guided by ZimLAC Assessment Report. As such, communities are asked to rank one another, and the ranking form is presented by order of vulnerability, with those most vulnerable being at the top of the list. In the event that the cut-off point is reached when we are at number 10 out of 30 who are on the ranking form, only the 10 will receive grain and the rest will not. The cut-off is also guided by grain availability, which could not cover everyone. This is then the reason why other food insecure households on the ranking form were not given grain.

3.2 Compliance with FDMS Procedures

The programme is supposed to follow the procedures that are outlined in the FDMS manual. During my audit, I noted that some of the procedures were not being fully adhered to as outlined below:

3.2.1 Registration/Ranking of Beneficiaries

Section 2.2.3 and 2.2.4 of the FDMS manual states that the approved DDRC list must be supported by the signed village ranking list indicating quorum on the day of ranking, pay sheets at the district level, and pay sheets at the distribution point. Facilitators should ensure that at least 80% of the households in the village are available.

Ranking registers for the 1 445 villages in the ten (10) out of thirteen (13) districts visited did not show the total number of household present during the registration to enable me to verify if the eighty percent (80%) quorum was reached for ranking to take place. However, Umguza had eight (8) out of twelve (12) villages and Goromonzi had two (2) out three (3) villages which met the quorum at registration. For Bulilima district all the hundred (100) ranking registers reviewed were indicating the quorum that was present on the registration day.

Furthermore, the 1 345 of the village ranking registers in twelve (12) out of the thirteen (13) districts were not signed by the Village Heads and verified by the FNC chairpersons except for Bulilima which had hundred (100) ranking registers signed. This may have been as a result of inadequate monitoring of the registration process by the Ministry and DDRC, which oversees and approves the registration process.

In Marondera and Masvingo districts, there were ten (10) and seven (7) wards respectively which had no evidence that the process for village ranking was followed or done. In Marondera, the DSDO highlighted that the funds to register the ten (10) wards were not released. For Masvingo

district, according to the interview with the DSDO, he indicated that beneficiary lists for the Wards were submitted by the DA Office. The District Office did not participate in the registration process nor do verifications for the lists that were received. There might be a risk that some families which were food insecure were left out from the lists.

Management Response

The observations are noted. As outlined in the FDMS Manual, all procedures are supposed to be followed from the start of the distribution period up to the end. Trainings are regularly conducted but are inadequate as witnessed by your office during the audit. Our district offices were short staffed due to brain drain as seasoned and trained Officers always seek for greener pastures outside the country. The Ministry however, trained some of the Officers but was left with only a few due to unavailability of funds, which sometimes resulted in compromising the implementation processes of the FDMS. However, Provinces are now conducting regular trainings for their district staff which is cost effective. The drought was the worst in 40 years and the Ministry did reasonably well under the circumstances.

When the disaster was declared, the Ministry had just concluded distributing for the lean season for the 2023/2024 season using the numbers for ZimLAC 2023. In April 2024, the ZimLAC 2024 report had not been concluded but already basing on the crop and livestock assessment it was clear that more people had become food insecure. When the President declared this as a national disaster, action had to be taken and whilst in some districts Officers managed to participate in the registrations, in other districts it was difficult and hence village-based registrations were called for to supplement registration on the ground. This was because there were not enough resources on the ground with regards to vehicles and fuel. Graduate interns had to be recruited to assist Officers and as time progressed, the Ministry managed to procure vehicles with the help of the Cabinet. It is in those instances that audit really did not find evidence of Officers having gone to register beneficiaries. Validations were done during the distributions attending to inclusion and exclusion errors.

Evaluation of Management Response

In Marondera and Masvingo districts, there were ten (10) and seven (7) wards respectively which had no evidence that the process for village ranking was followed or done. From the interviews with the Masvingo DSWO the DA's office brought the list without a request from the Ministry.

3.2.2 Beneficiary Verification

According to Section 2.5 of the FMDS Manual, following the registration of beneficiaries, it is critical to undertake beneficiary verification to minimise inclusion and exclusion errors. After the registration/ranking of beneficiaries, the DSDOs are supposed to check the accuracy and quality of source data before using or processing it. There was no evidence to confirm that beneficiary verifications were conducted by the districts except for Zaka district which had partly done verification. However, all the thirteen (13) district heads confirmed that they did not carry out verification and that they were responding to anonymous calls whenever they were issues raised and also on distribution days when they will be calling out household names and total number of beneficiaries in each household.

Furthermore, from review of paysheets for fifty-nine (59) villages in ten (10) districts, I noted that forty-eighty (48%) of the households' grain collections were done by proxies. There was no mechanism in place to follow up if the entitled beneficiaries had received the grain collected by their proxies. Verification on the existence of these beneficiaries could have assisted to ensure that the persons represented actually were in existence and that they received the grain. Table 7 shows an analysis of village households where food aid was collected by proxies.

Table 7: Village Households where Food Aid was Collected by Proxies.

District	Villages Sampled	Number of Households	Number of Proxies	% of Household Proxies
Marondera	3	50	18	36
Buhera	10	405	243	60
Mutare	4	182	119	65
Chipinge	1	6	6	100
Zaka	3	59	36	61
Masvingo	27	383	259	68
Umguza	2	325	119	37
Bubi	1	86	4	5
Bulilima	6	321	129	40
Gwanda	5	647	243	38
Totals		**2 464**	**1 176**	**48%**

Source: Village Paysheets.

According to interviews with the thirteen (13) DSDOs, verification of beneficiaries was not done due to shortage of vehicles to carry out the verifications. Documentary review and interviews at Head Office also revealed that the FDMS programme was facing severe shortage of motor vehicles for transporting enumerators to carry out the beneficiary verification and distribution of food aid. Reports from the Monitoring and Evaluation for February, March and May 2024 revealed that there were no vehicles in four (4) provinces and three (3) districts which they had visited. The Table below shows the status of the vehicles in the provinces/districts.

Table 8: Status of Vehicles in Provinces/Districts.

District/Province	Status of vehicles
Provinces	
Mashonaland Central	District vehicles not in good condition and late availability of vehicles to transport graduate interns who were supposed to assist in the monitoring of grain distribution.
Mashonaland East	There were no operational vehicles.
Mashonaland West	There were no operational vehicles.
Matabeleland North	2 districts out of the 7 had vehicles.
Districts	
Mzingwane	No vehicle for operations.
Insiza	Vehicle broken down.
Kwekwe	District office had no vehicle.
Umguza	District office had no station vehicle.
Bulilima	District office had no station vehicle.
Buhera	No vehicle for operations.
Chiredzi	No vehicle for operations.
Mutare	No vehicle for operations.

Source: Monitoring Reports February, March and May 2024.

In the absence of verification, there is a risk that some deserving beneficiaries may not be included on the village rankings while non-deserving get the grain or household sizes may be inflated.

Management Response

The observation is noted. Food distributions are guided by the FDMS Manual which provides for the beneficiary verifications to reduce errors of inclusion and exclusion. However, please take note that the Ministry has since procured vehicles for every district which is anticipated to improve all processes to do with food distributions.

Resource constraints led to verification not being done separately. Officers had no means to travel as highlighted earlier and had to travel in trucks which were ferrying grain. They would verify the beneficiaries as they distribute, so as to maximise on the limited resources that were available.

With regards to proxies collecting, the clientele that the Ministry assists in most cases are elderly, chronically ill and persons with disabilities who in most cases are not able to travel

to food distribution points. Proxies are nominated and registered by the beneficiaries themselves and accordingly, it is expected that this scenario will prevail and this is provided in the manual.

Evaluation of Management Response

The response is acknowledged. In future the proxies must also be recorded during the registration process as outlined on Section 2.2.3 of the manual.

3.2.3 Controls on Grain Withdrawal, Transportation and Distribution

According to the FDMS Manual section 10.7, prior Provincial Officer's authority should be sought in writing for the withdrawal of grain. A DSDO approved grain withdrawal slip is used with full details of the quantity, name of ward, truck details including the name of the driver and his ID Number to withdraw grain from the GMB. On issuance of grain, the GMB depot manager originates a grain release order. The Ward Food and Nutrition Committee would sign for the grain delivered to the FDP in grain delivery book.

The Ministry complied largely with the controls on grain withdrawal, transportation and distribution. However, all the 733 audited withdrawal slips were not signed by the Provincial Officers. Enquiries with the DSDOs revealed that they were preparing an itinerary which was sent for approval by the PSDOs instead of the withdrawal slips. This was not in line with Section 10.7 of the FDMS procedure manual.

I noted that in all the thirteen (13) districts visited, all the 733 audited grain withdrawals were accompanied by a GMB grain release order. Marondera had twenty-eight (28), Umguza eighty-six (86), Bubi forty-two (42), Bulilima forty-four (44), Gwanda twenty-five (25), Marondera twenty-eight (28), Goromonzi forty-five (45), Buhera ninety-five (95), Chiredzi eighty-five (85), Chipinge forty- seven (47), Zaka sixty-six (66), Masvingo eighty-eight (88), Mutare eighty-two (82) and Seke twenty-six (26). The grain release slip showed the quantity withdrawn, truck number, driver's name and ID number, name of police officer accompanying the delivery, the Ward and FDP.

However, there was no evidence that the grain delivery book was signed by the Food Distribution Committee. For the thirteen (13) districts visited, only two (2) districts that is Umguza and Bulilima were making use of the grain delivery book at every FDP. In Marondera, Zaka, Seke, Chiredzi, Mutare, Chipinge, Goromonzi and Masvingo districts, I noted that the districts did not have the delivery books. The other two (2) that is, Bubi and Gwanda districts, had the delivery books, however, the part of recipients and witnesses was not signed. In the absence of the grain delivery books, I was not able to confirm whether or not the grain withdrawn from GMB was reaching intended beneficiaries in the correct quantities.

Non-compliance to transportation and distribution procedures led to grain loss. For instance, a review of the internal audit reports dated August 21 and September 3, 2024 for Gutu and Uzumba Maramba Pfungwe districts, revealed that 180 and 122 bags of maize went missing respectively. In Gutu, ten (10) bags at Dewende Business Centre Ward 18 and 170 bags at Bhasera Shopping Centre went missing. The maize had been delivered at night without police escort. The Ward

Food and Nutrition Committee which was supposed to have guarded the maize was not advised by the District Development Officer to do so resulting in the loss. In Uzumba Maramba Pfungwe, at Karimbika Ward 11 distribution point, eight (8) bags of maize were sold by District Social Development Officer together with Visual Aid Assistant to a business person on May 18, 2024. The officers were arrested, appeared in court and were acquitted of the charges. The grain was not accompanied by a police officer on the day of delivery. This may have resulted from lack of supervision by the responsible Ministry officials and the DDRC.

Management Response

The observations are noted. As outlined in the FDMS Manual, all procedures are supposed to be followed from the start of the distribution period up to the end. Trainings are regularly conducted but are inadequate as witnessed by your office during the audit. Our district offices were short staffed due to brain drain as seasoned and trained Officers always seek for greener pastures outside the country. The Ministry however, trained some of the Officers but was left with only a few due to unavailability of funds, which sometimes resulted in compromising the implementation processes of the FDMS. However, Provinces are now conducting regular trainings for their district staff which is cost effective. The drought was the worst in 40 years and the Ministry did reasonably well under the circumstances.

3.2.4 Grain Quantities Issued to Beneficiaries

According to section 10.8 of the FDMS manual and the ZimLac report 2024, each beneficiary is required to receive a three-month allocation of grain at once which was pegged at 7.5kg per person per month for the period May to October 2024.

Review of paysheets in all the thirteen (13) districts visited revealed that the quantities each household was supposed to receive were shown against the household name. However, ten (10) pay sheets from Wards 12, 7 and 4 in Buhera district were not showing quantities collected by beneficiaries. As a result, I could not ascertain whether beneficiaries were receiving the required quantities.

Furthermore, review of ranking registers against the paysheets revealed that there were discrepancies between the number of beneficiaries on the ranking registers and beneficiaries as per the paysheets. For instance, Seke had nine (9, all received more), Marondera had seven (7, 6 received more while 1 received less), Umguza had two (2, 1 received more while 1 received less), Bulilima had three (3, all received less), Gwanda had eight (8, 6 received less, while 2 received more) and Mutare had forty-two (42, 9 received less, while 33 received more).

In addition, Mutare district issued food aid to beneficiaries whose Identification Numbers were not captured on the paysheet. For example, in Tonhorai Village, twenty (20), Manuwe Village, seventeen (17) and Makotamo Village, fourteen (14) beneficiaries had their Identification Numbers not captured on the paysheet. Zaka district had two (2) villages that is Svinurai and Ruzembe Villages which had thirty-three (33) and fifty (50) beneficiaries respectively without their Identification Numbers captured.

Also, a review of the internal audit reports dated September 3, 2024 for Uzumba Maramba Pfungwe districts, revealed that quantities issued to households were not specified on the paysheets which hindered verification of the quantities signed for by the beneficiaries.

In addition, interviews with the thirteen (13) DSDOs for the districts visited and the 405 questionnaires administered, revealed that the Ministry had no standard measuring containers or scales for the 7.5kg grain allocation issued. This was further collaborated by my visit at three (3) FDPs, in Goromonzi, Marondera (Munemo FDP) and Umguza. However, Marondera district had tins which were hand marked indicating the level of the approximated kilograms.

There is a risk that grain quantities issued to beneficiaries may be more/less than the approved quantity.

Management Response

The observations are noted. It is every beneficiary's right to receive what is due to them in the correct measurement. As such, the Ministry had made all the necessary procurement processes for scales/proper measuring containers, but due to budgetary constraints, the procurement could not be executed. Disbursement of resources from Treasury is unpredictable and also inadequate but the Ministry will lobby for procuring of these in batches.

The Ministry will continue training officials and also monitoring to ensure that paysheets are being completed correctly. Communities through the Food and Nutrition Committees will also be sensitised at the beginning of every cycle going forward so that they understand and know what to expect as they are signing for what they have received.

3.2.5 Reconciliation of Grain with GMB

According to the FDMS Manual section 10.17, at the end of each disbursement blitz, a copy of the duly acquitted pay sheets should, together with a copy of the voucher be submitted to GMB for purposes of reconciliation of grain summarizing the grain withdrawal slips issued in the month and the DSDO should send the signed copy to the provincial office for consolidation and onward submission to Head Office.

I noted that, five (5) out of the thirteen (13) districts visited were duly acquitting pay sheets together with a copy of the voucher and submitting the two (2) documents to GMB for purposes of reconciliation of grain withdrawn/issued in that month. The other eight (8) districts were not acquitting and these were Marondera, Goromonzi, Masvingo, Zaka, Chiredzi, Mutare, Buhera and Chipinge. Only a list of grain withdrawn from the local GMBs were maintained without confirmation from the GMB depot managers. There is a risk that errors may not be identified in time and also it may result in abuse of grain by officials. Inadequate performance of reconciliations may have been caused by lack of supervision by the Ministry.

Management Response

Trainings at sub-national level have since been strengthened since this modus operandi requires minimal resources. However, the national level continues to lobby for resources to continue with capacity building workshops for the remaining and newly recruited staff.

Whilst some districts did reconciliations during the period when grain was available at their local depots. Gaps emerged when they were collecting from other provinces. The

Ministry has since issued a circular to all Provinces asking them to reconcile and submit returns to Head Office and enforced that Officers follow the procedures.

3.2.6 Distances Travelled by Beneficiaries to FDPs

According to the FDMS manual Section 3.5, FDPs shall not be more than 5km away from the community. Interviews held with the thirteen (13) DSDOs in the thirteen (13) districts visited revealed that in nine (9) districts beneficiaries were travelling within the stipulated distance. The 405 questionnaires administered in the thirteen (13) districts visited also revealed that in nine (9) districts beneficiaries were travelling within the stipulated distance. However, five (5) DSDOs for Chiredzi, Masvingo, Umguza, Bubi and Marondera revealed that there were some FDPs where beneficiaries were travelling for more than the stipulated five (5) km radius. Chiredzi had seven (7) out of one hundred (100), Umguza had thirteen (13) out of fifty-nine (59) and Bubi had twenty-three (23) out of sixty-one (61) FDPs. In addition, Marondera had three (3) wards with one (1) food distribution point each with the furthest beneficiaries travelling for more than six (6) km to reach to the FDP.

A review of monitoring reports dated February, March, and May 2024 at Head Office revealed that beneficiaries from Lupane, Midlands, Mbembesi, and Mashonaland Central walked distances exceeding the stipulated five (5) km. In Mbembesi and Mashonaland Central the elderly and people with disabilities travelled more than fourteen (14) km and ten (10) km respectively to distribution points.

Interviews conducted revealed that some of these FDPs were impassible/inaccessible due to poor road network and in Matabeleland South transporters were hesitant to service the area because of the Kalahari sands.

There was a risk that the elderly and the chronically ill could fail to travel to the FDPs. In addition, beneficiaries could have a financial burden in terms of transport costs to travel to the FDPs and transport the received grain to their respective homes. From the 405 questionnaires administered, sixty-three (63) respondents indicated that there were financial burden in terms of transport cost to move grain to their homes.

Management Response

The observation is noted. The Ministry will continue to engage respective DDRCs on the issue of distribution points. However, it should also be noted that some areas are affected by impassable roads and lack of bridges, hence leaving the respective DDRC with no choice, but to maintain the already existing FDPs.

3.2.7 Contracts with Transporters

According to section 10.13.4 of the FDMS Manual, contracts of engagement for transporters should be drawn and signed before transportation of grain commence. From a review of the seventeen (17) contract documents submitted for audit in the thirteen (13) districts visited, I noted that nine (9) out of the thirteen (13) districts had valid contracts. The nine (9) districts with valid contracts were Mutare two (2), Chipinge six (6), Buhera two (2), Chiredzi, Zaka two (2) and Masvingo, Umguza, Bulilima and Gwanda had one (1) each.

The other four (4) districts had no valid contracts. Interviews held in four (4) districts, that is, Bubi, Seke, Marondera and Goromonzi, the DSDOs revealed that the districts had each submitted two (2) copies of the same contracts for signing to Head Office in August 2024, the signed copies were not yet sent back to the respective districts as at October 20, 2024. There was no evidence that follow up with the Head Office was made.

I further noted that all the contracts for transporters in the districts visited had no Section for the provision of the price agreed for carrying the grain. The prices were only highlighted on the due diligence reports for the seventeen (17) contracts and tender evaluation minutes.

Management Response

The Ministry acknowledges that at the time of audit, not all stations were able to expeditiously process the contracts due to different reasons, logistical constraints being one of them. However, the Ministry, having noted the challenge, designated the PSDOs as Sub-Accounting Officers for this purpose so as to expedite the contracting process. A standard contract template that provides for respective distances to distribution points and the corresponding cost therefore was shared with provincial offices.

3.2.8 Utilisation of Disbursed Funds

According to section 10.4 of the FDMS Manual, the drought relief Fund Account shall be solely used for the intended purpose as provided for in the constitution. Review of monthly reconciliations and acquittals made in all the provinces and districts visited revealed that funds disbursed amounting to ZWG47 348 779 in May and July were used for the intended purposes though in most cases the funds were not enough. From the inception of the programme, Treasury had only released a total amount of ZWG141 788 000 against a total amount of ZWG448 968 600 requested. For more details, refer to Tables 9 and 10.

Table 9: Funds Disbursed to the Respective Provinces and Districts.

	Amount Disbursed in ZWG		Total ZWG
Province/District	**15/5/2024**	**16/7/2024**	
Manicaland	1 668 000	2 349 422	4 017 422
Buhera	459 000	2 234 700	2 693 700
Chipinge	547 000	4 360 500	4 907 500
Mutare	565 000	4 338 300	4 903 300
Mash East	715 110	2 389 742	3 104 852
Goromonzi	423 000	1 849 200	2 272 200
Marondera	206 000	856 700	1 062 700
Seke	264 000	687 000	951 000
Matebeleland North	760 550	1 960 660	2 721 210
Bubi	154 000	725 500	879 500
Umguza	200 000	1 282 400	1 482 400
Matebeleland South	503 230	2 013 020	2 516 250

Bulilima	154 000	704 900	858 900
Gwanda	317 000	1 335 200	1 652 200
Masvingo-Province	991 040	2 376 105	3 367 145
Chiredzi	542 000	3 894 200	4 436 200
Masvingo	487 000	2 407 500	2 894 500
Zaka	481 000	2 146 800	2 627 800
Total	**ZWG 9 436 930**	**ZWG 37 911 849**	**ZWG 47 348 779**

Source: Release Letters from Treasury.

Table 10: Treasury Releases.

Date Requested	Amount Requested ZWG	Date Received	Amount Received ZWG	Variance ZWG
Not provided	223 836 840	May 13, 2024	34 150 000	189 686 840
June 27, 2024	225 131 760	July 16, 2024	113 638 000	111 493 760
Total	**ZWG 448 968 600**		**ZWG 147 788 000**	**ZWG 301 180 600**

S*ource: Treasury Releases.*

My review of Internal Audit reports and interviews with four (4) senior managers, five (5) middle managers and thirteen (13) low level managers revealed that allocation of funds to provinces and districts was done without actual requests. This would enable the Head Office to determine the requirements of the various provinces and districts. This was contrary to Section 10.6 of the FDMS manual, which requires Provinces and Districts to formally request for funds from Head Office.

Management Response

With the declaration of the disaster, indeed the Head Office disbursed funds to provinces and districts without requests. There was need to expedite resource disbursements and with officials inundated with grain distributions, registrations among other social protection activities this was done as a stop gap measure. However, the paper work is now being done to regularize this anomaly as the Ministry issued a circular asking Provinces to comply.

3.2.9 Monitoring and Evaluation

According to section 9 of the FDMS Manual the Ministry, through the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Department shall conduct monthly, quarterly and annual monitoring on the programme implementation, processes and outcomes. My audit revealed that Mashonaland East, Masvingo Manicaland, Matabeleland North and Matabeleland South provincial offices were conducting monitoring activities. They were producing monthly and quarterly reports where issues on implementation, processes and outcomes and challenges were highlighted and addressed. Matabeleland South provincial office was also producing weekly performance reports for the programme. By regularly monitoring and evaluating progress and assessing performance, programme implementers can identify areas of success and areas for improvement. This

information can be used for decision making, improve programme design and implementation, and ultimately increase the chances of achieving desired outcomes. Monitoring and evaluation can also help identify and address issues early.

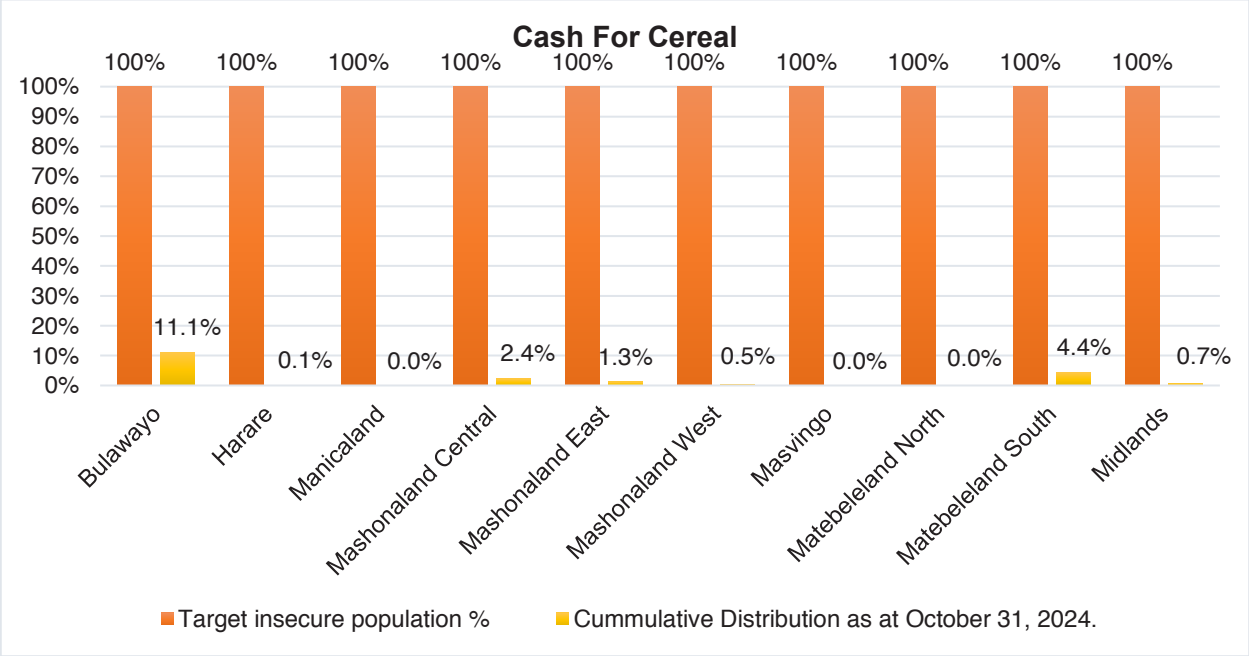
Management Response

The Ministry acknowledges the need for monitoring and evaluation. It will endeavour to enforce that monitoring and evaluation is conducted and reports are produced.

3.3 Disbursements of Cash for Cereal in Urban Areas

The El Nino -Induced Drought Document for the Cash for Cereal Programme Urban Response indicated that the programme was supposed to commence with the registration of potential beneficiaries and the transfers would be done after the verification process as from July 2024 until March 2025. I noted from the paysheets that the cash for cereal transfers did not start in July as planned. The first disbursements were made on October 9, 2024. Only 28 875 (2%) out of the targeted population of 1.4 million beneficiaries nationwide had received the cash for cereal disbursements as at October 31, 2024. A total amount of ZWG6 300 001 had been disbursed as at October 31, 2024. Seven (7) out of ten (10) provinces had received cash for cereals with Bulawayo having the highest coverage of eleven percent (11.1%) followed by Matebeleland South with four percent (4.4%), Mashonaland Central (2.4%), Mashonaland East (1.3%), Midlands (0.7%) and Mashonaland West (0.5%) while Manicaland, Masvingo and Matebeleland North had zero percent (0%) coverage. Graph 3 below shows the cash for cereal targeted population and the beneficiaries that had benefited as at October 31, 2024. For further details on the Cash for Cereal programme, refer to **Annexure E.**

Graph 3: Cash for Cereal Disbursement as at October 31, 2024.



Source: Summary of Cash for Cereal Payments.

The causes for late disbursements were delays in training of the CCWs who were supposed to conduct the registration processes of beneficiaries and inadequate number of CCWs in line with the population which needed to be registered. The authority to train CCWs was issued on July 16, 2024 and all the thirteen (13) districts held the training in August. The following Table shows the Number of CCWs needed per District for the Cash for Cereal Programme.

Table 11: CCWs Needed per District for the Cash for Cereal Programme.

District	Target Population	Required Target for Cash for Cereal	Number of CCWs Required	Number of CCWs Available	Ratio of CCWs to Target Population	Progress as at October 31, 2024.
Buhera	11 257	2 758	36	25	1: 450	Still on registration.
Mutare	238 108	55 491	76	24	1: 9 921	Still on registration.
Chipinge	71 459	15 344	22	21	1:3 403	On verification process.
Gwanda	10 791	10 791	10	82	1: 132	Disbursement was done to some beneficiaries.

Source: District Reports.

Management Response

The CCWs were only assisting during the declared drought in urban areas and are yet to be paid their token of appreciation due to non-availability of resources. In a normal situation, their role is confined to community services which do not require that they get allowances. The CCW usually get the trainings for specific programmes, which are mostly identification of social protection issues in their respective areas. Community Care Workers are voluntary community cadres who offer their services freely. They are not paid hence cannot be fully engaged to deal with disbursement of cash for cereal.

When the programme commenced, Treasury had to avail resources once registration was completed. By October 2024, a substantial number had been registered and Treasury was advised, to which they availed ZWG6.3 million. The amount managed to pay 28 875 individuals from 5 780 households. From October 2024, until the end of the programme (March 2025), Treasury did not avail any more resources for cash for cereal hence no payments could be made.

3.4 Payment of Travel and Subsistence Allowances to Staff Members

Section 65 (6) of the Public Finance Management (Treasury Instructions), 2019 states that Officers may, on application, be paid a subsistence allowance in advance as the Accounting

Officer may authorize. The subsistence allowance shall cover the cost of meals and accommodation when an Officer is away from their home station.

Review of claim forms for Travel and Subsistence allowances from nine (9) out of thirteen (13) districts visited revealed that the Ministry was owing US$166 848 to officers as at October, 20 2024. According to the claim forms, some of the allowances had been outstanding since April 2024 as shown in the following Table.

Table 12: Outstanding Travel and Subsistence Allowances.

District	**Amount (US$)**
Zaka	15 738
Masvingo	4 790
Chipinge	77 825
Gwanda	900
Bubi	21 150
Bulilima	7 135
Umguza	7 560
Buhera	1 845
Chiredzi	29 905
Total	**US$166 848**

Source: Travel and Subsistence Allowance Claim Forms.

From the above Table, Chipinge district had the highest amount of outstanding Travel and Subsistence allowances as compared to other districts. My interview with the six (6) DSDOs whose Travel and Subsistence allowances were not paid revealed that this was attributed to the long distances travelled to the FDPs, which required the officers to sometimes sleep over before grain distributions. Goromonzi and Mutare districts were up to date with the payment of Travel and Subsistence allowances. However, for Marondera and Seke district, the information was not availed for audit.

A review of the districts' budget statements also revealed that the Travel and Subsistence allowances were not budgeted for. This had resulted in the districts failing to settle claims when they were due. None of the thirteen (13) districts visited was able to provide disbursement requests for Travel and Subsistence allowances. Interviews with DSDOs revealed that budgets developed included only operational Travel and Subsistence allowances and did not include allowances for the FDMS programme. Hence, the disbursements made were based on availability of funds from the Ministry's Head Office. Delays to pay Travel and Subsistence allowances may negatively impact on staff motivation and it also gives room for unethical practices.

Management Response

These were budgeted for within the administration costs of the programme. Funds received from Treasury were limited and thus priority had to be given to transporters who were currently owed ZWG230 million. The Ministry is working with Treasury to gradually pay these allowances as and when resources are availed.

CHAPTER 4: CONCLUSIONS

This chapter presents audit conclusions based on the audit objective provided in Chapter one of this report. The conclusions are categorized into two main parts; the general audit conclusion and specific audit conclusions.

4.1 General Audit Conclusion

Although the Ministry provided food aid to a significant portion of the targeted population for the 1st blitz and 2nd blitz, the assistance fell short by eleven percent (11%) and twenty-eight percent (28%) respectively. The Ministry only managed to provide two percent (2%) of cash for cereal to the targeted population. This indicates that the Ministry needs to improve its operations so that food aid is distributed to all the targeted people as per schedule.

The percentage of those not receiving food aid may continue to increase in the next blitz if the logistical and distribution challenges identified are not addressed.

The level of food insecure population in the country is more than the projected six (6) million target as more ranked people or those in need of food aid are not included in the six (6) million.

4.2 Specific Audit Conclusions

4.2.1 The movement of grain between depots is not well planned hence affecting the distribution of the grain.

4.2.2 Delays in disbursement of cash for cereal means that the urban population will continue to be affected by food insecurity than their counterparts in rural areas.

4.2.3 There is no full adherence to FDMS procedures. The issues below are noted:

- The transparency of the village ranking process is compromised if the quorum for registration is not present.
- High rate of proxies during grain collections raises concerns on the existence of the registered beneficiaries since there is no follow up mechanisms to ascertain whether beneficiaries have eventually received the grain.
- Failure to utilise grain delivery books could be an oversight by staff members and can be an indication of inadequate training of staff.
- Varying quantities to beneficiaries affects the transparency and accountability of the programme.
- Errors are not detected in time when reconciliations are not done.
- If the Food Distribution Points are not within the prescribed distance, the beneficiaries will be burdened with transport costs.
- The Ministry will face litigation cases if payments to transporters remain outstanding hence the distribution in the subsequent distribution will be affected.
- It seems that the drought relief programme is not receiving priority in terms of funding as evidenced by the delays in release of funds.
- Although Monitoring and Evaluation is being done, the challenges in the programme needs to be addressed in time.

4.2.4 Failure to pay Travel and Subsistence allowances to staff members affects morale and gives room for unethical practices.

CHAPTER 5: RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter provides recommendations to the Ministry to improve distribution of food and cash aid to the vulnerable population. The recommendations to the Ministry are as follows:

5.1 The Ministry should make sure that there is timeous coordination with GMB so that grain is readily available in all depots to enable the districts to obtain grain within reasonable distances. This will reduce the time travelled by transporters and time taken to deliver to the beneficiaries.

Movement of grain between depots should be properly planned with indicative dates to enable follow ups to be made. The Ministry should liaise with Treasury on the issue of timeous release of funds to pay transporters so that the programme activities are not interrupted. This will ensure that the food insecure population receive aid timeously.

5.2 The Ministry should make sure that all FDMS procedures from the registration, verification and payment of food aid are enforced to enhance accountability and transparency in the implementation of the programme. Furthermore;

5.2.1 The Ministry should ensure that the registration/ranking of villagers is conducted across all wards and villages to enhance transparency and integrity of the programme.

Due processes should be followed in identifying beneficiaries and avoid District Development Officers (former DA Office) from providing lists of beneficiaries to the District Social Development Officers. This process is supposed to be carried out by the District Social Development Office and the villagers.

5.2.2 The Ministry should carry out beneficiary verifications in order to minimise inclusion of non-deserving and exclusion of deserving beneficiaries. Mechanisms to follow up on the beneficiaries whose food aid is collected by proxies should be developed. This will assist in determining the existence of the beneficiaries and whether they have received food aid. For the districts which did not have motor vehicles, alternative arrangements for transportation of staff such as hiring of vehicles for verifications should have been sought for the exercise to be done within reasonable time.

5.2.3 The Ministry should train staff members on how to complete the delivery books and also provide the delivery books to all the districts. This will assist in monitoring the movement of grain from GMB to the distribution centers. In cases, where the grain cannot be distributed on the same day, the consignment should be formally handed over to the FNC so that it is safely secured overnight. All deliveries should have a police escort.

5.2.4 The Ministry should provide proper measuring containers/scales so that beneficiaries receive the correct quantities and avoid estimations which might give room for misappropriation of grain.

5.2.5 The Ministry should ensure that grain reconciliations are made with GMB for proper accountability of the grain that would have been withdrawn and distributed in provinces.

5.2.6 The Ministry in consultation with the Ward Food and Nutrition Committees should create other FDPs so that the distance travelled by beneficiaries is reduced. This will remove the financial burden for beneficiaries on transport costs.

5.2.7 The Ministry should expedite signing of contracts submitted by districts. In the case that

disagreements arise with the contractors it will be difficult to handle the issues without valid contracts. In addition, the contract document should include contract price for it to be complete and binding.

5.2.8 The Ministry should sustain the proper utilisation of disbursed funds for the benefit of the vulnerable. In addition, the Ministry should intensify mobilisation of financial resources to address the financial gaps so that more people receive food aid.

5.2.9 The Monitoring and Evaluation should be enhanced to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of the programme especially in cases where weaknesses and gaps would have been identified.

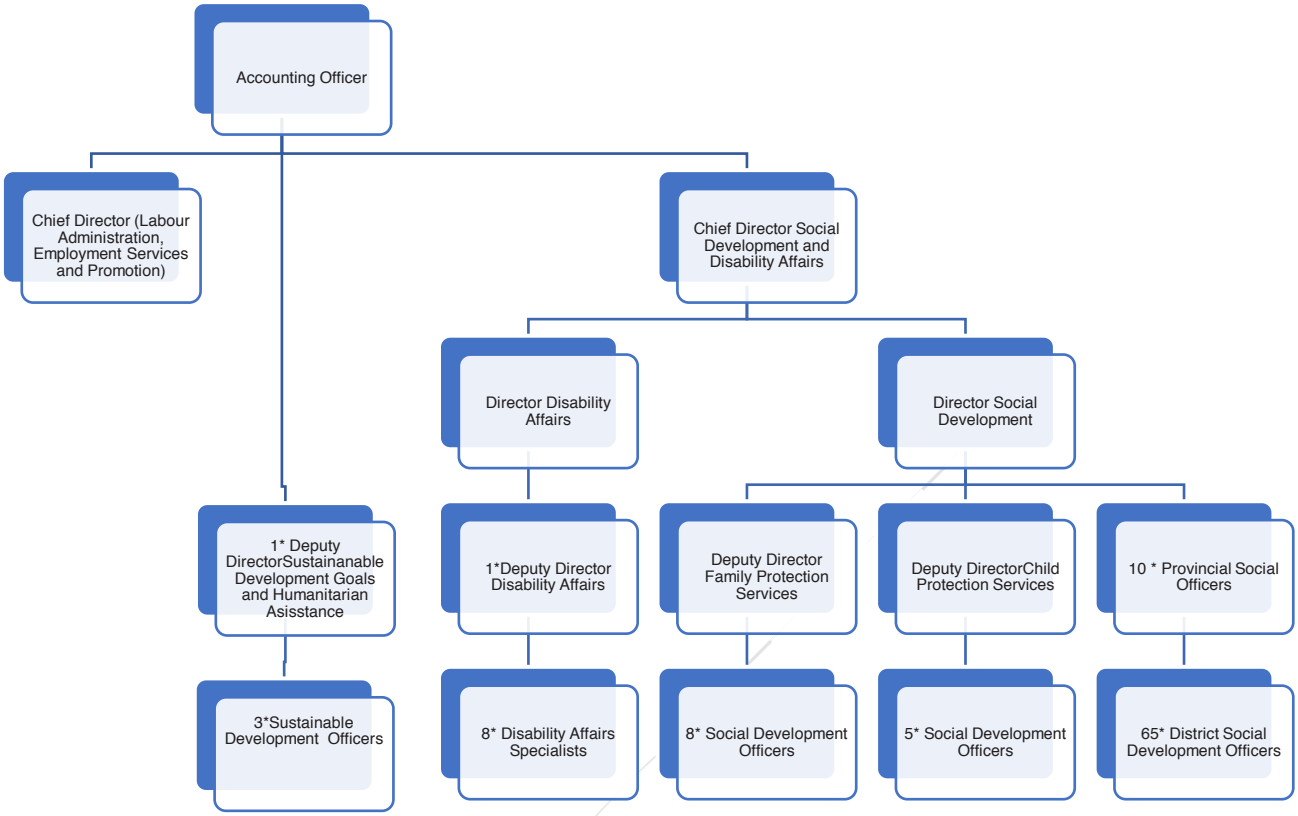
5.3 The Ministry should increase numbers and expedite the training of CCWs. This will assist registrations to be carried out in time and allow all food insecure population to receive aid.

5.4 The Ministry's budgets formulation should be comprehensive to include provision for FDMS Travel and Subsistence allowances so that staff are paid promptly.

The Ministry should strive to clear all outstanding Travel and Subsistence allowances and pay in time so that the wellbeing and morale of the staff implementing the programme is enhanced.

Annexures

Annexure A: Organogram.



Source: Ministry Organisational Structure.

Annexure B: Documents Reviewed.

Document	Purpose
FDMs Manual	Understanding how the programme was executed and also coming up with the basis for the evaluation of the programme.
FDMS Budgets and plans	Determining the budgeted amount for the programme.
Programme Plans	Determining the itinerary for grain distribution.
Circulars	Obtaining information or instructions or change on programme implementation.
Fuel Registers	To determine whether fuel for the programme was used solely for programme activities.
Acquittals	To determine utilisation of disbursed funds.
Minutes of Committees	To determine progress and challenges encountered in executing the programme
Disbursement Reports	To determine amounts disbursed for the programme to provinces and districts.
Internal Audit Reports	Understanding some of the issues raised by internal auditors that may be of use pertaining to the programme.
Monitoring and Evaluation Reports	Verifying whether monitoring reports were produced on a weekly, monthly and quarterly basis. Identification of areas that needed improvements and reviewing the subsequent reports to verify whether the gaps were addressed.
2024 ZimLac Report	Understanding the estimation of the rural population that was likely to be food insecure in the 2024/2025 consumption year, their geographic distribution and the severity of their food insecurity.
Minutes of Meetings (DDRC)	Understanding issues discussed during meetings which were in line with the programme.

Village Ranking Registers	Verifying whether ranking sheets had all the necessary requirements as per the FDMS manual.
Paysheets	Verifying whether beneficiaries on the paysheets were in agreement with those on the village ranking sheet, verifying whether all the details on the paysheet were correctly captured and verifying whether beneficiaries were signing for the actual amount of grain received.
Grain withdrawal slips	Verifying whether grain quantities withdrawn were authorised by the DSDOs.
GMB Release	Verifying if quantities requested were tallying with quantities released to the wards.
Grain Delivery Book	Verifying if quantities received at FDPs were tallying with quantities released from GMB.
Contracts with Transporters	Verifying validity of contracts in place.
Travel and Subsistence claim forms	Calculation of outstanding Travel and Subsistence allowances.
Invoices	Verifying outstanding arrears for Transporters.
Payment Vouchers	Verifying authorisation and purpose of payments.

Annexure C: Detailed Percentages of Grain Requirements and Distributions.

	Total Population to benefit	Required/ Target	Cumulative Distributed		Total Population to benefit	Required/ Target	Cumulative Distributed	
			1st Blitz as @July 31				2nd Blitz as @ October 31	
		Actual (MT)	Actual (MT)	%		Actual (MT)	Actual (MT)	%
Manicaland								
Buhera	208 078	4 682	4 662	100%	208 078	4 682	3 960	85%
Chimanimani	77 354	1 740	1 740	100%	77 354	1 740	1 305	75%
Chipinge	236 050	5 311	5 311	100%	236 050	5 311	2 919	55%
Makoni	171 475	3 858	3 189	83%	171 475	3 858	3 523	91%
Mutare	178 524	4 017	4 017	100%	178 524	4 017	3 123	78%
Mutasa	131 606	2 961	1 619	55%	131 606	2 961	2 163	73%
Nyanga	84 227	1 895	1 385	73%	84 227	1 895	1 412	75%
Totals	**1 087 314**	**24 464**	**21 923**	**90%**	**1 087 314**	**24 464**	**18 405**	**75%**
Mashonaland Central								
Bindura	93 379	2 101	2 101	100%	93 379	2 101	451	21%
Guruve	55 913	1 258	1 258	100%	102 401	2 304	2 304	100%
Mazowe	125 559	2 825	2 825	100%	150 592	3 388	2 465	73%
Mbire	59 848	1 347	1 347	100%	59 848	1 347	1 347	100%
Mt Darwin	126 751	2 852	2 852	100%	126 751	2 852	2 003	70%
Muzarabani	60 846	1 369	1 369	100%	60 846	1 369	1 369	100%
Shamva	61 696	1 388	1 388	100%	61 696	1 388	144	10%
Rushinga	42 743	962	962	100%	42 743	962	961	100%
Totals	**626 735**	**14 102**	**14 102**	**100%**	**698 256**	**15 711**	**11 044**	**70%**

Annexure C Continued: Detailed Percentages of Grain Requirements and Distributions.

Mashonaland East								
Chikomba	65 932	1 483	1 483	100%	65 932	1 483	650	44%
Goromonzi	228 416	5 139	2 109	41%	228 416	5 139	4 004	78%
Hwedza	44 623	1 005	1 005	100%	44 623	1 005	1 004	100%
Marondera	65 103	1 465	1 465	100%	65 103	1 465	1 465	100%
Mudzi	122 345	2 753	1 336	49%	122 345	2 753	2 753	100%
Murehwa	120 459	2 710	2 710	100%	120 459	2 710	2 121	78%
Mutoko	100 521	2 262	1 819	80%	100 521	2 262	2 262	100%
Seke	83 399	1 876	1 344	72%	83 399	1 876	1 876	100%
UMP	94 412	2 124	1 607	76%	94 412	2 124	2 062	97%
Totals	**925 210**	**20 817**	**14 878**	**71%**	**925 210**	**20 817**	**18 197**	**87%**
Mashonaland West								
Chegutu	103 053	2 319	2 287	99%	103 053	2 319	1 678	72%
Hurungwe	194 664	4 380	4 386	100%	194 664	4 380	3 624	83%
Kariba	32 957	742	691	93%	32 957	742	465	63%
Makonde	104 980	2 362	2 005	85%	104 980	2 362	1 254	53%
Mhondoro-Ngezi	63 933	1 438	1 436	100%	63 933	1 438	691	48%
Sanyati	88 553	1 992	1 966	99%	88 553	1 992	891	45%
Zvimba	215 230	4 843	4 126	85%	215 230	4 843	3 199	66%
Totals	**803 370**	**18 076**	**16 897**	**93%**	**803 370**	**18 076**	**11 802**	**65%**
Masvingo								
Bikita	78 015	1 755	1 755	100%	78 015	1 755	1 235	70%
Chivi	146 581	3 298	3 298	100%	146 581	3 298	1 969	60%
Chiredzi	171 332	3 855	3 855	100%	171 332	3 855	3 813	99%
Gutu	106 198	2 389	2 144	90%	108 937	2 451	407	17%
Masvingo	153 896	3 463	3 386	98%	153 896	3 463	1 925	56%

Annexure C Continued: Detailed Percentages of Grain Requirements and Distributions.

Mwenezi	143 639	3 232	2 970	92%	143 639	3 232	2 695	83%
Zaka	151 805	3 416	3 416	100%	151 805	3 416	2 226	65%
Totals	**951 466**	**21 408**	**20 824**	**97%**	**954 205**	**21 470**	**14 270**	**66%**
Matabeleland North								
Binga	136 210	3 065	2 511	82%	136 210	3 065	2 628	86%
Bubi	48 497	1 091	1 091	100%	48 497	1 091	236	22%
Hwange	50 899	1 145	1 145	100%	50 899	1 145	1 011	88%
Lupane	68 210	1 535	1 314	86%	68 210	1 535	1 176	77%
Nkayi	65 421	1 472	942	64%	65 421	1 472	1 130	77%
Tsholotsho	69 283	1 559	1 139	73%	69 283	1 559	1 366	88%
Umguza	82 004	1 845	1 845	100%	82 004	1 845	1 503	81%
Totals	**520 524**	**11 712**	**9 987**	**85%**	**520 524**	**11 712**	**9 050**	**77%**
Matabeleland South								
Beitbridge	37 525	844	844	100%	37 525	844	844	100%
Bulilima	48 715	1 096	1 096	100%	48 715	1 096	1 096	100%
Gwanda	68 681	1 545	1 545	100%	68 681	1 545	1 348	87%
Insiza	54 237	1 220	1 220	100%	54 237	1 220	1 220	100%
Mangwe	33 703	758	758	100%	33 703	758	664	88%
Matobo	42 965	967	967	100%	43 556	980	907	93%
Umzingwane	36 510	821	821	100%	36 510	821	821	100%
Totals	**322 336**	**7 251**	**7 251**	**100%**	**322 927**	**7 264**	**6 900**	**95%**
Midlands								
Chirumhanzu	52 209	1 175	1 175	100%	52 209	1 175	1 175	100%
Gokwe North	192 327	4 327	3 914	90%	192 327	4 327	558	13%

Annexure C Continued: Detailed Percentages of Grain Requirements and Distributions.

Gokwe South	219 355	4 935	3 030	61%	219 355	4 935	1 878	38%
Gweru	84 904	1 910	1 611	84%	84 904	1 910	1 692	89%
Kwekwe	126 798	2 853	2 853	100%	126 798	2 853	2 316	81%
Mberengwa	132 247	2 976	2 686	90%	132 247	2 976	1 718	58%
Shurugwi	39 089	880	880	100%	39 089	880	700	80%
Zvishavane	57 040	1 283	1 283	100%	57 040	1 283	1 283	100%
Totals	**903 969**	**20 339**	**17 432**	**86%**	**903 969**	**20 339**	**11 320**	**56%**

Annexure D: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	Ward Number	Planned Date of Distribution	Actual Date of Distribution	Delays in Days
UMGUZA (First Blitz)	15	14/5/2024	31/5/2024	17
	1	23/5/2024	7/6/2024	15
	1	28/05/2024	8/6/2024	11
	2	30/5/2024	11/6/2024	12
	2	3/6/2024	12/6/2024	9
	2	5/6/2024	13/6/2024	8
	2 and 3	5/6/2024	13/6/2024	8
	3	7/6/2024	15/6/2024	8
	2 and 3	11/6/2024	18/6/2024	7
	4	11/6/2024	19/6/2024	8
	4 and 5	12/6/2024	19/6/2024	7
	5	12/6/2024	20/6/2024	8
	5 and 6	13/6/2024	20/6/2024	7
	7	14/6/2024	21/6/2024	7
	6	14/6/2024	21/6/2024	7
	6	15/6/2024	22/6/2024	7
	6 and 7	15/6/2024	22/6/2024	7
	8	17/6/2024	25/6/2024	8
	19	18/6/2024	25/6/2024	7
	19	19/6/2024	26/6/2024	7
	8	19/6/2024	26/6/2024	7
	8	19/6/2024	27/6/2024	8
	9	20/6/2024	29/6/2024	9
	9	20/6/2024	30/6/2024	10
	10	21/6/2024	2/7/2024	11
	10	21/6/2024	3/7/2024	12
	11	25/6/2024	4/7/2024	9
	13	27/6/2024	9/7/2024	12
	11	28/6/2024	9/7/2024	11
	11	2/7/2024	10/7/2024	8
	13	3/7/2024	10/7/2024	7
	13	3/7/2024	11/7/2024	8
	19	4/7/2024	11/7/2024	7
	12	4/7/2024	11/7/2024	7
	14	4/7/2024	11/7/2024	7
	14	5/7/2024	12/7/2024	7
	14	5/7/2024	17/7/2024	12
	13	9/7/2024	17/7/2024	8
	14	11/7/2024	19/7/2024	8
	18	11/7/2024	19/7/2024	8

Annexure D Continued: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	17	12/7/2024	23/7/2024	11
	12	15/7/2024	24/7/2024	9
	17	15/7/2024	24/7/2024	9
	16	15/7/2024	24/7/2024	9
	17	16/7/2024	25/7/2024	9
	16	16/7/2024	25/7/2024	9
	14	17/7/2024	25/7/2024	8
	16	18/7/2024	30/7/2024	12
	16	19/7/2024	31/7/2024	12
	16	22/7/2024	1/8/2024	10
Average				**9**
Second Blitz	8	23/7/2024	6/8/2024	14
	9	24/7/2024	6/8/2024	13
	11	25/7/2024	6/8/2024	12
	15	6/8/2024	23/8/2024	17
	19	8/8/2024	23/8/2024	15
	15	9/8/2024	24/8/2024	15
	19	13/8/2024	24/8/2024	11
	19	14/8/2024	25/8/2024	11
	18	22/8/2024	4/9/2024	13
	18	27/8/2024	5/9/2024	9
	19	28/8/2024	5/9/2024	8
	14	28/8/2024	5/9/2024	8
	14	29/8/2024	6/9/2024	8
	13	30/8/2024	8/9/2024	9
	14	3/9/2024	8/9/2024	5
	12	3/9/2024	11/9/2024	8
	13	3/9/2024	12/9/2024	9
	12	4/9/2024	13/9/2024	9
	14	4/9/2024	13/9/2024	9
	10	5/9/2024	18/9/2024	13
	12	6/9/2024	18/9/2024	12
	13	6/9/2024	18/9/2024	12
	9	6/9/2024	18/9/2024	12
	9	9/9/2024	20/9/2024	11
	18	9/9/2024	21/9/2024	11
	9	12/9/2024	21/9/2024	9
	11	13/9/2024	22/9/2024	9
	8	16/9/2024	24/9/2024	8
	8	16/9/2024	26/9/2024	10
	11	17/9/2024	27/9/2024	10
	14	18/9/2024	27/9/2024	9

Annexure D Continued: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	8	18/9/2024	27/9/2024	9
	7	19/9/2024	27/9/2024	8
	7	19/9/2024	28/9/2024	9
	2	20/9/2024	31/09/2024	11
	7	20/9/2024	31/09/2024	11
	16	20/9/2024	31/09/2024	11
Average				**10**
BUBI (First Blitz)	19	1/6/2024	3/6/2024	2
	21	2/6/2024	4/6/2024	2
			8/6/2024	6
	20	3/6/2024	10/6/2024	7
			11/6/2024	8
	6	4/6/2024	13/6/2024	9
			14/6/2024	10
	15	5/6/2024	17/6/2024	12
	5	6/6/2024	20/6/2024	14
	4	8/6/2024	21/6/2024	13
			24/6/2024	16
	17	9/6/2024	21/6/2024	12
	18	10/6/2024	21/6/2024	11
	9	11/6/2024	25/6/2024	14
			26/6/2024	15
	13	12/6/2024	27/6/2024	15
	14	15/6/2024	4/7/2024	19
			5/7/2024	20
			5/7/2024	20
	22	16/6/2024	4/7/2024	18
			5/7/2024	19
	10	17/6/2024	5/7/2024	18
	12	18/6/2024	9/7/2024	21
	2	19/6/2024	12/7/2024	23
			15/7/2024	26
	11	22/6/2024	15/7/2024	23
	7	23/6/2024	17/7/2024	24
			18/7/2024	25
	16	24/6/2024	18/7/2024	24
			19/7/2024	25
			23/7/2024	29
	3	25/6/2024	25/7/2024	30
			30/7/2024	35
	23	26/6/2024	30/7/2024	34

Annexure D Continued: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	1	29/6/2024	31/7/2024	32
			1/8/2024	33
	8	30/6/2024	5/8/2024	36
Average				**19**
Second Blitz	21	7/9/2024	11/9/2024	4
	15	13/9/2024	19/9/2024	6
Average				**5**
BULILIMA (First Blitz)	10	27/5/2024	18/6/2024	22
	20	10/6/2024	17/6/2024	7
	1	18/6/2024	20/6/2024	2
	21	24/6/2024	26/7/2024	32
	14	7/6/2024	26/7/2024	49
	8	30/5/2024	28/7/2024	59
	13	31/5/2024	29/7/2024	59
	5	6/6/2024	29/7/2024	53
	12	28/5/2024	30/7/2024	63
	11	29/5/2024	30/7/2024	62
	9	25/6/2024	30/7/2024	35
	2	21/6/2024	31/7/2024	40
	17	19/6/2024	31/7/2024	42
Average				**40**
Second Blitz	14	22/8/2024	28/8/2024	6
	19	21/8/2024	27/8/2024	6
	6	21/8/2024	27/8/2024	6
	5	22/8/2024	28/8/2024	6
	15	23/8/2024	29/8/2024	6
	16	23/8/2024	29/8/2024	6
	20	26/8/2024	23/9/2024	28
	1	28/8/2024	30/9/2024	33
	2	27/8/2024	30/9/2024	34
	3	26/8/2024	1/10/2024	36
	4	27/8/2024	2/10/2024	36
Average				**18**
GWANDA (First Blitz)	21	29/5/2024	30/5/2024	1
	15	17/6/2024	19/6/2024	2
	16	19/6/2024	26/6/2024	7
Average				**3**
GOROMONZI				
	3	12/6/2024	25/7/2024	43
			26/7/2024	44
			30/7/2024	47
	5	19/6/2024	5/8/2024	47

Annexure D Continued: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	10	13/6/2024	26/7/2024	44
			27/7/2024	45
			28/7/2024	46
			30/7/2024	48
			31/7/2024	49
	11	7/6/2024	18/7/2024	41
			19/7/2024	42
			22/7/2024	45
			23/7/2024	46
			24/7/2024	47
			25/7/2024	48
			26/7/2024	49
	12	31/5/2024	11/6/2024	10
			12/6/2024	11
			8/7/2024	37
			9/7/2024	38
			10/7/2024	39
			12/7/2024	41
			13/7/2024	42
			16/7/2024	45
			17/7/2024	46
			22/7/2024	51
	13	14/6/2024	30/7/2024	46
			31/7/2024	47
	15	3/7/2024	30/7/2024	26
	16	5/6/2024	12/7/2024	37
			15/7/2024	40
			17/7/2024	42
			19/7/2024	44
			23/7/2024	48
	17	11/6/2024	22/7/2024	41
			23/7/2024	42
	18	29/5/2024	10/6/2024	11
	20	18/6/2024	1/8/2024	44
	25	17/6/2024	30/7/2024	44
			31/7/2024	45
Average				**41**
CHIREDZI				
	7	23/8/2024	12/9/2024	20
	7	23/8/2024	12/9/2024	20
	6	23/8/2024	12/9/2024	20

Annexure D Continued: Delays in Food Distribution by Districts.

	7	23/8/2024	12/9/2024	20
	7	23/8/2024	12/9/2024	20
	10	23/8/2024	24/9/2024	31
	12	31/8/2024	19/9/2024	19
	11	31/8/2024	17/9/2024	17
	11	31/8/2024	25/9/2024	25
	10	1/9/2024	16/9/2024	15
	10	1/9/2024	18/9/2024	17
	12	1/9/2024	27/9/2024	26
	6	2/9/2024	15/9/2024	13
	6	2/9/2024	17/9/2024	15
	6	2/9/2024	20/9/2024	18
	6	2/9/2024	24/9/2024	22
	9	3/9/2024	13/9/2024	10
	6	3/9/2024	13/9/2024	10
	10	4/9/2024	26/9/2024	22
	9	4/9/2024	12/9/2024	8
	9	4/9/2024	27/9/2024	23
	9	5/9/2024	27/9/2024	22
	10	5/9/2024	29/9/2024	24
	12	5/9/2024	29/9/2024	24
Average				**19**
MASVINGO	34	22/8/2024	30/8/2024	8
	34	24/8/2024	5/9/2024	12
	22	25/8/2024	27/8/2024	2
	30	27/8/2024	29/8/2024	2
	16	28/8/2024	29/8/2024	1
	1	29/8/2024	30/8/2024	1
	12	1/9/2024	2/9/2024	1
	2	1/9/2024	24/9/2024	23
	6	1/9/2024	24/9/2024	23
	2	3/9/2024	24/9/2024	21
	24	10/9/2024	27/9/2024	17
	32	13/9/2024	27/9/2024	14
	7	20/9/2024	26/9/2024	6
Average				**10**

Annexure E: Cash for Cereal Target Population and Beneficiaries as at October 31, 2024.

Province	Province/ District	Targeted insecure population		Cumulative Distribution to date 31/10/24		Amount Paid in ZWG
				Second Blitz		
		Actual	%	Actual	%	
Bulawayo	Bulawayo	219 845	100%	24293	11.1%	5 148 173
Harare	Harare	599 183	100%	395	0.1%	82 160
Manicaland		105 192	100%	0	0.0%	0
Mashonaland Central	Mt Darwin, Mazowe	17 250	100%	411	2.4%	85 488
Mashonaland East	Marondera	63 541	100%	849	1.3%	187 856
Mashonaland West	Kadoma, Kariba, Makonde	140 383	100%	656	0.5%	136 448
Masvingo		37 833	100%	0	0.0%	0
Matabeleland North		30 255	100%	0	0.0%	0
Matabeleland South	Gwanda, Mangwe, Beitbridge	26 097	100%	1154	4.4%	240 032
Midlands	Shurugwi	158 886	100%	1117	0.7%	232 336
Transaction Charges						187 508
Totals		**1 398 465**	**100%**	**28 875**	**2.1%**	**6 300 001**

Printed by Printflow (Private) Limited